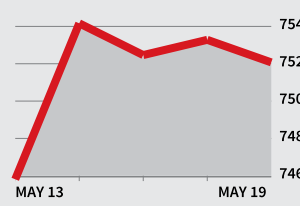


the hindu businessline

SENSEX 75200.85 (-114.19)



IN FOCUS

	LATEST	CHANGE
Nifty 50	23618.00	-31.95
P/E Ratio (Sensex)	20.30	-0.03
US Dollar (in ₹)	96.53	+0.19
Gold Std 10 gm (in ₹)	158440.00	+1333
Silver 1 kg (in ₹)	268713.00	+673



FOSTERING TIES.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi discusses with Nordic leaders ways to strengthen ties in digitalisation, clean energy and trade **p9**

DEDICATED BOARD.

Plans are afoot to set up a ‘Basmati Development Board’ on the lines of various commodities boards **p10**

BENGALURU - CHENNAI - COIMBATORE - HUBBALLI - HYDERABAD - KOCHI - KOLKATA - MADURAI - MALAPPURAM - MANGALURU - MUMBAI - NOIDA - THIRUVANANTHAPURAM - TIRUCHIRAPPALLI - VIJAYAWADA - VISAKHAPATNAM

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Governance cloud dogs Tata stocks; ₹10 lakh crore lost since Sept 2024

VALUE EROSION. Lag peers as succession, Trusts-related issues since Ratan Tata’s death hit sentiment

Akshata Gorde
Mumbai

Continuing governance and succession-related uncertainty within the Tata Group has begun to weigh visibly on investor sentiment, with listed Tata companies losing nearly ₹10 lakh crore in market value since Ratan Tata died in October 2024.

Data sourced from Prime Database show the combined market capitalisation of 21 listed Tata companies declined 28.7 per cent to ₹24.4 lakh crore in March 2026, from ₹34.2 lakh crore on September 30, 2024, nine days before Ratan Tata passed away. Tata Group indices also sharply underperformed broader markets and rival business groups during the period.

The ‘Nifty India Corporate Group Index – Tata Group’ declined over 32 per cent between September 2024 and March 2026, while the ‘Nifty Tata Group 25 Cap Index’ fell 28 per cent. In comparison, the Nifty 50 declined around 13.5 per cent during the same period, while indices for Mahindra Group and Aditya Birla Group were down only around 5 per cent each, according to NSE Indices data.

Key metrics

	Sep 2024	Mar 2026	Change (%)
Combined market cap of 21 listed Tata Companies (₹ lakh crore)	34.2	24.4	(28.7)
Nifty India Corporate Group Index - Tata Group (pts)	19,850	13,417	(32)
Nifty Tata Group 25 Cap Index (pts)	18,453	13,256	(28)
Nifty 50 Index (pts)	25,811	22,331	(13.5)

Source: NSE Indices, primeinfobase.com

cording to NSE Indices data.

FPIs have also pared stakes across Tata companies with the sharpest reduction seen in premium growth-oriented businesses that witnessed strong valuation re-rating during the post-Covid rally.

The sharp reduction in foreign ownership coincided with steep market-cap erosion across several Tata companies. Tata Motors Passenger Vehicles saw its market cap decline nearly 70 per cent since September 2024, while Tejas Networks lost more than 66 per cent of its value. Tata Consultancy Services, Tata Chemicals, Trent, Tata Technologies and Tata Elxsi also witnessed market-cap erosion of around 40 per cent or more during the period. Meanwhile, Tata Steel saw a rise of nearly 14 per cent in its market cap to ₹2.4 lakh crore as of March.

₹2.4 lakh crore as of March.

Market participants said the divergence suggests investors have become increasingly selective within the Tata universe at a time when governance visibility, succession planning and leadership continuity at the group level have drawn greater attention.

GROWING TUSSLE

Tata Trusts, which holds a little over 66 per cent in the Group holding company Tata Sons, is seeing a tussle among trustees over key issues, such as listing of Tata Sons and nominees on its board, while there is uncertainty over N Chandrasekaran getting another term as its Chairman. Another dimension was added to the internal strife with complaints of alleged violations of the Maharashtra Public Trusts Act, which led

to a key trustees meeting being postponed twice.

“Ever since Ratan Tata’s death, they have taken quite some time to come out of the mess, but they have taken some solid steps to address the public perception of the Group,” said Arun Kejriwal, Founder of Kejriwal Research and Investment Services. “Wherever there is controversy, investors take a bit of a backseat,” he said.

“The market is effectively pricing in uncertainty at the holding-company level, even though the operating businesses remain fundamentally strong,” said a fund manager who did not wish to be identified.

Analysts said global risk aversion and correction in richly valued stocks have worsened sentiment across markets in recent months. However, the sharper underperformance in Tata Group companies and indices began well before the latest phase of global volatility.

“Markets can live with weak quarters, but they struggle with uncertainty around leadership and structure. That’s when investors start assigning a higher risk premium,” said a senior market participant.

FPIs pare Tata stake p2

Power demand hits record 260 GW on Tuesday on rising mercury, heat waves

Rishi Ranjan Kala
New Delhi

The peak power demand on Tuesday hit a new record high of 260 GW as rising temperatures and heat wave conditions upped the demand for cooling.

“Today, the peak power demand (solar hours) of 260.45 GW was met successfully at 15:40 hrs. This is a new high surpassing Monday late afternoon peak demand (solar hours) of 257.37 GW which was also successfully met,” the Power Ministry said on X.

The previous record peak power demand of 256.1 GW on April 25 at 15:38 hrs was also met successfully without any shortage.

According to the Grid Controller, Monday’s peak power demand during the day hit 257.37 GW (15:42 hours). The evening peak demand stood at 241.24 GW.

69% MET BY COAL UNITS

Coal-based thermal power plants accounted for 69 per cent of the generation on Monday to meet the demand, followed by 28 per cent from renewable energy sources.

The peak shortage on Monday stood at 601 MW and the energy met stood at



5.62 billion units. However, generation outage was on the higher side at 32.54 GW.

The India Meteorological Department said day temperatures (maximum) were in the range of 38-47 degree Celsius over the north-west region, west, central, adjoining east and north peninsular India on Monday. Several parts of the country experienced heat wave to severe heat wave conditions. These included Uttar Pradesh, Madhya Pradesh, the Vidarbha region of Maharashtra, Jammu and Rajasthan.

SURGE IN DELHI

The national capital witnessed record power demand on Tuesday. The peak power demand touched 7,776 MW (at 3:30 pm), the highest recorded so far in 2026. On Monday, Delhi’s peak power demand reached 7,542 MW in the afternoon and increased to 7,600 MW during the night.

Fuel prices hiked for a second time within a week

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Public sector oil marketing companies (OMCs) on Tuesday raised the retail price of petrol and diesel by around 90 paise a litre, making it the second hike in less than a week.

The increase pushed up petrol prices in New Delhi to ₹98.64 per litre from ₹97.77, while diesel rose to ₹91.58 from ₹90.67 a litre. On May 15, the OMCs raised pump prices of petrol and diesel by ₹3 per litre and of compressed natural gas (CNG) by ₹2 per kg.

Details p3

Closure of cases in US set to provide relief to Adani Group

Our Bureau
Ahmedabad

The closure of multiple investigations and cases in the US involving Chairman Gautam Adani and his nephew Sagar is expected to provide significant relief to the Adani Group as it pursues aggressive expansion across airports, renewable energy, ports, transmission and data centre businesses, while also keeping its fund-raising plans active in global debt markets.

The shares of Adani Group companies witnessed a mixed trend on Tuesday.

Read more p2

StanChart to slash over 15% corporate function roles globally

Sindhu Hariharan
Chennai

Standard Chartered has said that it will cut around 15 per cent of its corporate function roles globally by 2030.

In an internal email to employees, titled ‘Our Next Phase of Growth’, the global

bank said that transformation is ongoing, and the process of change will impact over 15 per cent of corporate functions by 2030.

As of end-2025, StanChart employed 28,000 people in India, of whom 22,000 were part of its Global Business Services operations.

Details p7

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Petrol, diesel prices raised by 90 paise per litre

CASCADING EFFECT. Second price hike within a week likely to lift retail inflation further

Our Bureau
New Delhi

The public sector oil marketing companies (OMCs) on Tuesday raised the retail price of petrol and diesel by around 90 paise a litre, making it the second hike in less than a week.

The increase pushed up petrol prices in New Delhi to ₹98.64 per litre from ₹97.77, while diesel rose to ₹91.58 from ₹90.67 a litre. On May 15, the OMCs raised the retail prices of petrol and diesel by around ₹3 per litre and compressed natural gas (CNG) by ₹2 per kg.

Dhananjay Sinha, CEO & Co-Head Institutional Equities at Systematix Group, said, “This is on expected lines. The initial ₹3 hike was significantly small compared to the under recovery faced by OMCs. It covered only 8 per cent. We had been expecting a cumulative rise of 15 odd rupees. It



FUEL PRESSURE. The increase pushed up petrol prices in New Delhi to ₹98.64 per litre from ₹97.77, while diesel rose to ₹91.58 from ₹90.67 a litre SHIV KUMAR PUSHRAKAR

appears the government has chosen to allow small but frequent rises.”

WAR IMPACT

The retail prices of petrol and diesel had been unchanged since March 2024. They were last reduced by ₹2 per litre ahead of the Lok Sabha elections in 2024.

Effectively, the prices have been raised for the first time

after April 2022. Sources said the impact of the West Asia conflict and the resultant increase in cost of crude oil, LPG and LNG, which has been absorbed by the PSU OMCs, had severely impacted the refiners. Besides, a weak rupee vis-a-vis the US dollar is further exacerbating the crisis.

“The two raises hardly make up for the losses. Sure,

the government is doing cross subsidisation by increasing commercial LPG, CNG prices, but that is not enough. We expect at least a couple more hikes in retail prices of petrol and diesel in Q1 FY27,” said a senior executive with a top refiner.

Sinha emphasised that inflationary pressure is likely to accentuate as a consequence. The WPI inflation is rising to 8.4 per cent in April and it could rise beyond 10 per cent soon.

Besides, retail inflation is also expected to rise to 6-7 per cent in the second half of FY27. All of this is likely to impact reach income of households and their spending power, thereby slowing the overall growth, he added.

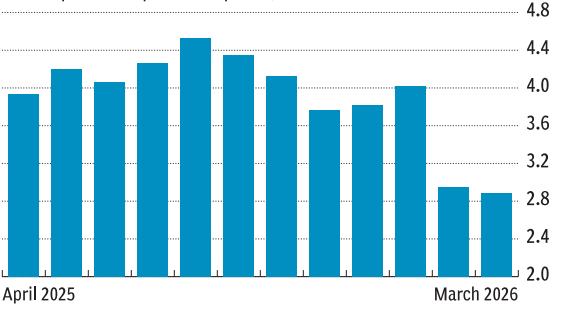
The government is also trying to contain the oil import bill and limit fuel consumption. Last week, Prime Minister Narendra Modi urged people to conserve fuel, work from home and reduce non-essential travel.

LPG supply disruption pulls India’s March petroleum product imports to 8-year low

Rishi Ranjan Kala
New Delhi

War impact

Refined petroleum product imports (in million tonnes)



Source: PPAC

ily due to a 397,000 b/d fall in LPG imports, slightly offset by ‘other products’, which in the case of India generally consists of bitumen. Year-on-year, product imports were down 476,000 b/d, or 38 per cent,” it added.

SUPPLY DISRUPTION

India’s crude oil imports fell to an eight-month low of 4.5 mb/d in March 2026, due to trade flow disruptions and despite a temporary suspension of sanctions. Month-on-month crude imports into India declined by 7,75,000 b/d or almost 15 per cent, the OPEC MOMR said.

The International Energy Agency (IEA), in its latest commentary on the impact of the West Asia conflict on LPG flows, said, “India’s LPG imports have been particularly affected, dropping by more than half over the first two months (March-April 2026) of the conflict, a loss of around 4,30,000 b/d.”

The impact of supply side

disruptions on liquefied petroleum gas (LPG) imports by India also reflected in consumption of the commodity — the key cooking fuel for more than 33.50 crore households.

The OPEC report pointed out that LPG consumption witnessed the largest decline in March 2026 of about 120,000 b/d y-o-y, in March, down from a y-o-y increase of 100,000 b/d in February 2026.

As per PPAC, India’s LPG consumption fell by almost 16 per cent m-o-m and 13 per cent y-o-y to 2.38 million tonne (mt) on a provisional basis — the lowest in the last 21 months.

However, India’s cumulative LPG consumption in FY26 rose by 6 per cent y-o-y to 33.21 mt on a provisional basis, which is the highest annual growth in usage since FY19.

APPOINTMENT



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DATE FOR FILING ONLINE APPLICATION & PAYMENT OF FEES: FROM 13.05.2026 to 02.06.2026.

Place: Mumbai

Date: 13.05.2026

General Manager (RP & PM)

‘Quality compliance must for Indian exporters under EU FTA’

Amiti Sen
New Delhi

Indian exporters seeking to benefit from tariff elimination under the India-EU free trade agreement (FTA) will have to up their game to meet the bloc’s stringent quality regulations, but the government can challenge the requirements that seem to restrict trade, officials said.

“Compliance is something on which we have to all work. And work is required in preparing ourselves in terms of ensuring that we produce quality goods, we take proper certifications and we comply with the requirements of the importing country. For that, we have to improve our systems. At the same time, the FTA provides for a number of mechanisms to ensure that technical regulations do not become impediments,” said Darpan Jain, Additional Secretary, Ministry of Commerce.

Mechanisms, such as early warning transparency, rapid action mechanism and joint TBT & SPS (technical barrier to trade & sanitary and phytosanitary measures)



committees, have been in-built into the FTA to ensure that genuine regulations do not become an impediment to exports, Jain said.

The India-EU FTA, which is set to eliminate tariffs on 99 per cent of India’s exports (by value) to the region, is likely to be implemented sometime next year after its legal scrubbing is completed, and it goes through all ratification processes, including the approval of the EU Parliament.

Compliance with the EU’s complex regulatory standards will be critical for Indian businesses as the EC has made its intentions clear by stating that “human, animal, and plant health are non-negotiable,” pointed out development economist Biswajit Dhar.

“Though the government is optimistic about its gains

from this FTA, the realisation of benefits may not be as straightforward as it appears, given that the EU is an extensive user of standards, or non-tariff measures,” Dhar said.

GAINS FROM FTA

Enumerating gains from the FTA, Jain said that about 99.5 per cent of Indian exports will receive preferential tariff treatment, while \$33 billion worth of labour-intensive goods — apparel, textiles, leather, footwear and gems and jewellery — currently facing high EU duties of 10-14 per cent, and going up to 26 per cent in some categories (like marine) — will benefit from full elimination.

The combined imports of India and the EU represent roughly one-third of global trade in goods and services, he said.

Noting that the EU accounts for about 12 per cent of India’s total merchandise trade, FICCI Secretary General Anant Swarup said the task now is to convert these agreements into practical gains for industry, especially for exporters, MSMEs and service providers.

West Asia crisis to moderate India’s GDP growth in FY27: Rating agencies

Shishir Sinha
New Delhi



While Ind-Ra expected growth to be 6.7 per cent, ICRA cut its GDP forecast to 6.2 per cent from 6.5 per cent

improved capital flows could also boost GDP growth beyond the current estimate.

Arora listed geopolitical developments, particularly the West Asia conflict, high headline inflation, a depreciated currency from weak capital inflows, weaker-than-expected capex, weak global trade growth, strong FY26 growth (base effect), low industrial production as measured by the Index of Industrial Production, and notably, the likely El Nino weather pattern from mid-2026 as major headwinds.

ICRA CUTS FORECAST

ICRA lowered its forecast for FY27 and FY26. For FY26, ICRA estimated GDP growth at 7.5 per cent, marginally lower than the National Statistical Office’s (NSO) Second Advance Estimate (SAE) of 7.6 per cent for the fiscal. “ICRA now assumes crude oil prices to average at \$95/bbl in FY27, against our prior estimate of \$85/bbl,

given the ongoing stickiness in prices amid the stalemate in West Asia. Consequently, we have pared our baseline forecast for the FY27 GDP growth (at constant 2022-23 prices) to 6.2 per cent from the 6.5 per cent expected earlier,” ICRA Chief Economist Aditi Nayar said.

The rating agency also said GDP growth in the fourth quarter is expected to ease to a three-quarter low of 7 per cent from 7.8 per cent in Q3 of 2025-26.

A slower expansion across the industrial and services sectors is expected to have moderated GDP growth between these quarters.

“However, a slower rise in manufacturing volumes, contraction in exports, and nascent signs of margin pressure amid the West Asia fallout may have weighed on the industrial gross value added growth performance in the quarter. Consequently, we expect the GDP growth to have slowed to a three-quarter low of 7 per cent in Q4 2025-26, below the NSO’s implicit estimate of 7.3 per cent for the quarter, while remaining quite robust,” Nayar said.

Slowing global growth and shipping disruptions triggered by the West Asia conflict weighed on merchandise exports in the March quarter, which fell by 2.8 per cent on a y-o-y basis, after a modest 1.4 per cent rise in the December quarter.

Putin to travel to India in September to attend BRICS Leaders’ Summit

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Russian President Vladimir Putin will travel to New Delhi to attend the 18th BRICS Leaders’ Summit, scheduled on September 12-13, the Kremlin has confirmed. The confirmation was made via a social media post by the Russian Embassy in South Africa on Tuesday, quoting senior Kremlin foreign policy aide Yury Ush-



Vladimir Putin

akov. The visit will mark Putin’s second trip to New Delhi in less than a year, following his attendance at the

23rd India-Russia Annual Summit in December 2025.

The BRICS Leaders’ Summit, traditionally attended by heads of states of the membership, is set to face a rigorous diplomatic test, especially if there is no let-up in the ongoing Israel-U.S. war with Iran by that time.

The grouping’s Foreign Ministers failed to achieve a joint declaration during their meeting this month amid “diverging views” on the situation in West Asia.

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STATEMENT OF STANDALONE AND CONSOLIDATED AUDITED FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER AND YEAR ENDED 31ST MARCH 2026

(₹ in Crore)

Sr. No.	PARTICULARS	STANDALONE						CONSOLIDATED					
		FOR QUARTER ENDED			FOR THE YEAR ENDED			FOR QUARTER ENDED			FOR THE YEAR ENDED		
		31.03.2026	31.12.2025	31.03.2025	31.03.2026	31.03.2025	31.03.2026	31.12.2025	31.03.2025	31.03.2026	31.03.2025		
1	Revenue from Operations	2,32,855.33	2,31,769.04	2,17,725.44	8,86,224.41	8,45,512.61	2,36,899.33	2,36,257.24	2,21,360.24	9,01,452.70	8,59,362.73		
2	Other Income	1,629.89	1,222.44	1,173.42	4,988.31	4,963.84	1,774.96	1,160.45	1,237.84	4,162.99	3,513.73		
3	Total Income	2,34,485.22	2,32,991.48	2,18,898.86	8,91,212.72	8,50,476.45	2,38,674.29	2,37,417.69	2,22,598.08	9,05,615.69	8,62,876.46		
4	Total Expenses	2,19,162.85	2,16,999.92	2,10,113.19	8,42,428.31	8,36,432.13	2,19,532.56	2,20,057.35	2,12,834.10	8,51,119.17	8,49,411.46		
5	Net Profit/(Loss) for the period before Share of Profit/(Loss) of Associates and Joint Ventures, Exceptional Items and Tax	15,322.37	15,991.56	8,785.67	48,784.41	14,044.32	19,141.73	17,360.34	9,763.98	54,496.52	13,465.00		
6	Share of Profit/(Loss) of Associates and Joint Ventures	-	-	-	-	-	649.31	466.51	279.62	2,975.56	1,760.43		
7	Net Profit/(Loss) for the period before Exceptional Items and Tax	15,322.37	15,991.56	8,785.67	48,784.41	14,044.32	19,791.04	17,826.85	10,043.60	57,472.08	15,225.43		
8	Net Profit/(Loss) for the period before Tax	15,322.37	15,991.56	8,786.72	48,784.41	15,882.34	19,791.04	17,826.85	10,044.65	57,472.08	17,063.45		
9	Net Profit/(Loss) for the period after Tax	11,377.51	12,125.86	7,264.85	36,802.42	12,961.57	15,176.08	13,502.26	8,367.63	43,677.32	13,788.83		
10	Net Profit/(Loss) for the period after Tax attributable to Equityholders of the Parent	-	-	-	-	-	14,458.08	13,006.92	8,123.64	42,096.26	13,597.84		
11	Total Comprehensive Income for the period [Comprising Profit/ (Loss) for the period (after tax) and Other Comprehensive Income (after tax)]	14,677.40	12,190.70	8,233.37	39,639.54	11,602.16	19,308.89	13,977.79	10,350.29	48,408.80	12,938.87		
12	Total Comprehensive Income for the period attributable to Equityholders of the Parent	-	-	-	-	-	18,578.57	13,485.89	10,108.21	46,804.45	12,735.92		
13	Paid-up Equity Share Capital (Face value - ₹10 each)	14,121.24	14,121.24	14,121.24	14,121.24	14,121.24	14,121.24	14,121.24	14,121.24	14,121.24	14,121.24		
14	Other Equity excluding revaluation reserves	-	-	-	1,90,772.78	1,64,905.30	-	-	-	2,05,745.99	1,72,715.76		
15	Securities Premium Account	-	-	-	-	-	79.94	79.94	79.94	79.94	79.94		
16	Net Worth (Total Equity excluding Non-controlling Interest)	2,04,544.34	1,92,621.30	1,78,676.86	2,04,544.34	1,78,676.86	2,19,517.55	2,03,687.71	1,86,487.32	2,19,517.55	1,86,487.32		
17	Outstanding Debt	1,10,668.22	1,15,947.51	1,34,465.54	1,10,668.22	1,34,465.54	1,20,089.13	1,24,864.54	1,42,559.90	1,20,089.13	1,42,559.90		
18	Debt Equity Ratio (Times)	0.54	0.60	0.75	0.54	0.75	0.53	0.60	0.75	0.53	0.75		
19	Earnings per Share (₹) (Basic and Diluted) (Face value - ₹10 each)	8.26	8.81	5.28	26.72	9.41	10.50	9.44	5.90	30.57	9.87		
20	Capital Redemption Reserve	-	-	-	-	-	0.42	0.42	0.42	0.42	0.42		
21	Bond Redemption Reserve	-	-	-	-	-	18.75	18.75	18.75	18.75	18.75		
22	Debt Service Coverage Ratio (Times)	2.22	3.08	1.06	2.39	1.07	2.26	4.15	0.94	2.41	1.02		
23	Interest Service Coverage Ratio (Times)	10.33	9.63	6.17	7.98	4.02	12.45	10.18	6.58	8.81	4.13		

Place: New Delhi
Dated: 18 May, 2026

Notes: 1. The Board of Directors have recommended the final dividend of ₹1.25 per equity share (face value of ₹10/- per equity share) for Financial Year 2025-26 subject to approval by the members of the Company in the Annual General Meeting.
2. The above is an extract of the detailed format of Financial Results filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 & Regulation 52 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of the Financial Results are available on the Stock Exchange websites i.e. BSE Limited (URL: <https://www.bseindia.com/xml-data/corplisting/AttachLive/cde05dd83-2d1f-44ea-b92f-51c3ba7d678d.pdf>) & National Stock Exchange of India Limited (URL: https://nsearchives.nseindia.com/corporate/IOC_18052026214359_Financial_Results_Q4_2025_26_S.pdf) and also on the company's website (www.iocl.com).

BY ORDER OF THE BOARD

Sd/-
(ANUJ JAIN)
DIRECTOR (FINANCE)
DIN: 10310088

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Short-term biz vision

MBA's are market managers, not industry builders

Prabir Kumar Bandyopadhyay

When Uday Kotak recently warned at a Confederation of Indian Industry forum that India was becoming “over-financialised” and excessively focused on quarterly performance, he raised a concern that goes far beyond stock markets. His remarks touched the very character of Indian capitalism and the direction in which India’s managerial and entrepreneurial ecosystem is evolving.

Kotak argued that Indian businesses must move beyond quarterly obsessions and begin thinking with a three-to-five-year horizon. He also rightly hinted that start-ups must move beyond a “proof-of-concept” mindset. A start-up should not merely demonstrate an idea attractive enough to secure the next funding round. It should aspire to evolve into a robust industrial or technological institution capable of generating long-term productive capacity.

Indeed, over a decade, India has created a vibrant start-up culture, but much of it has also become heavily valuation-driven. In many cases, entrepreneurship appears oriented toward fundraising rounds and aggressive valuation expansion rather than building enduring industrial enterprises.

This widespread short-termism is linked to the fact that MBA curricula worldwide have become remarkably standardised, with a focus on finance. Whether in India, Europe, or North America, the dominant frameworks remain similar — corporate finance, valuation, consulting models, marketing analytics, and short-cycle business optimisation.

Such standardisation may suit mature developed economies where industrial ecosystems are already established. India’s developmental needs, however, are different. The country is still building manufacturing depth, technological capability, and supply-chain resilience. Its management education therefore cannot merely replicate templates designed for post-industrial service economies.

Yet much of Indian MBA education continues to mirror globalised managerial frameworks without adapting sufficiently to India’s strategic realities.

This educational orientation is reinforced by market incentives. Across Indian MBA campuses, finance, consulting, analytics, and consumer-oriented sectors



WANTED. Technology creators PTI

dominate student aspirations because they offer significantly higher compensation and social prestige than manufacturing or industrial operations.

This was not always the case in India. During the mid-1980s, many public-sector enterprises represented some of the country’s most aspirational workplaces. Large organisations in energy, telecommunications, steel, and heavy engineering attracted brilliant graduates from institutions like the IITs because they offered not only respectable salaries, but also professional prestige, housing, healthcare, social infrastructure, and long-term career stability. Engineers and managers felt they were participating in national development and industrial creation rather than merely pursuing individual advancement.

Over time, however, liberalisation, financial-sector expansion, and service-led growth altered the hierarchy of opportunity. Today, many manufacturing companies struggle to offer the compensation and professional ecosystem required to attract top managerial and technical talent.

CURRICULUM REVAMP

MBA institutes therefore need to redesign parts of their curriculum with greater industry immersion in factories, industrial clusters, and deep-technology enterprises that can help students understand the realities of productive capability creation beyond balance-sheet management. In fact, the National Education policy provides an interdisciplinary framework that can support such industry-oriented and application-driven management education.

India therefore must encourage entrepreneurs not merely to become assemblers, traders, or digital intermediaries, but genuine manufacturers and technology creators.

The writer is a retired management professor

THE WIDER ANGLE.



PARAN BALAKRISHNAN

It’s a straight fight between two Chinese auto industry giants BYD and CATL. Both want to offer the world’s fastest electric vehicle (EV) charging systems. CATL is claiming to be in the top spot currently with its third-generation Shenzheng battery which it says can speedily charge a vehicle from 10 per cent to 98 per cent in just 6 minutes and 27 seconds. That makes it faster than BYD’s second-generation battery which claims it can race from 10 per cent to 90 per cent in 9 minutes.

The Adani group is looking to tie-up with CATL for a gigantic battery manufacturing project near its Khavda Renewable Energy Park. The only catch is that the Chinese would prefer to make as much as possible in China and export to India. Now Reliance is also in talks with CATL to buy components for the huge battery energy storage systems complex that it is planning to build at Jamnagar. Soon after the 2020 border clash India issued what was euphemistically called Press Note 3 to curb investments and purchases from companies based in neighbouring countries. This move was obviously aimed at China but the government has been forced to introduce relaxations at regular intervals. Most recently in March it eased up by allowing BHEL and SAIL to buy critical equipment from China. “The policy statement that came out was essentially an acknowledgement that blocking Chinese investments had created a lot of negative spillovers,” says Santosh Pai, partner Dentons Link Legal.

IMPORTS ZOOM

The government’s goal of hitting China hard on trade didn’t work out. The trade figures tell the whole story. In FY20 India’s imports from China were at \$65 billion. But imports have been climbing steeply ever since and in FY26 had zoomed to \$131 billion.

The inescapable fact is that China has become the factory of the world and scores of products and also industrial equipment aren’t available — or are much costlier — anywhere else. Yes, the US is still ahead in hi-technology and fields like AI. But in many other industries it’s a very different story.



GETTY IMAGES

Chinese stranglehold on EV components

India has plans to manufacture EV and cellphone parts. But for now we’re reliant on Chinese imports

Just glance at the automobile industry and this becomes almost brutally visible. In EVs and batteries the Chinese are roaring ahead and the German and American giants are only just starting to catch up.

Take Tata Motors and partner companies like Tata Autocomp. Tata Motors buys its battery packs from Chinese giant Gotion High-Tech and the cells in those batteries from Gotion, EVE Energy and other smaller companies. Then check out the EV motors and drivetrain which are from another Chinese firm Prestolite Electric.

It’s the same story at Mahindra & Mahindra which mostly buys BYD Blade battery cells and lithium-ion pouch cells from Farasis Energy, another Chinese company with advanced technology. But Mahindra may drive away from the

Tata Motors, Mahindra and Maruti Suzuki are all crucially dependent on China for components for their electric vehicles. The story is similar in solar panels

Chinese in the near future and is looking for a tie-up with Volkswagen, But the fact is that currently Indian companies buy all their key components from Chinese companies. Even Maruti Suzuki which has been late getting into EVs buys battery packs from BYD. Also rare earth magnets for most companies come from China.

Move from EVs to solar panels and it is much the same story. China is reckoned to produce 80 per cent to 85 per cent of all solar panels globally. It’s much the same story for other solar energy components like wafers, solar cells and polysilicon. Over 80 per cent of all these components are produced in China. Indian manufacturers are buying a small amount of their hardware from countries like Vietnam, Malaysia, Indonesia and Thailand but even here the manufacturers are Chinese companies that have set up shop in South-East Asia. What about the US and Europe — they’re generating hardly any heat in solar energy. Yes. Indian manufacturers are swinging into action but could take time to make their presence felt.

Smartphone production has been one of India’s great success stories in recent years. Apple, Samsung and even Chinese

companies like Xiaomi are all putting together their products in India but it shouldn’t be tough to guess where the components are coming from: China. Even Apple still gets components from China. Whether it’s printed circuit boards or any other electronics component, it’s almost certain to come from China.

What about pharmaceuticals, one of the great Indian success stories? Soon after the Ladakh confrontation it dawned on the government that India’s pharma stars had all shut down the plants that once made active pharmaceutical ingredients. Why? They brought in lower returns was the main reason. Of course they were also very polluting but that probably wasn’t the key reason for getting out of these fields.

Even in less hi-tech fields the world has allowed China to take over manufacturing of all kinds. So industrial machinery in all kinds of fields is almost inevitably from the Middle Kingdom.

Is it possible to change this situation? Yes, the world has woken up to just how dependent it has become on the Chinese. And India will soon start manufacturing its EV and smart phone components. But for now China has our arms firmly twisted behind our backs.

STATISTALK.

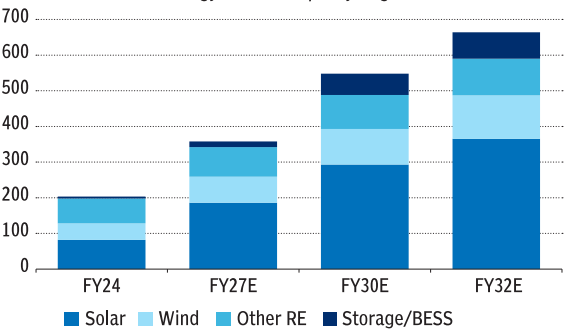
Compiled by Vasupradha Sandeep, intern | Graphic KS Gunasekar

How solar is leading India’s power shift

A report from Valuequest Investment Advisors shows how India’s rising energy needs are set to be fulfilled by solar energy. The National Electricity Plan (NEP) envisages non-fossil capacity of over 650 GW by FY32, primarily driven by new solar capacity. The solar industry and its ancillaries, therefore, are projected to undergo exponential growth to ₹4.5 lakh crore of total addressable market by FY35. As the third largest solar energy producer, India’s capacity has grown rapidly, led by utility-scale and rooftop segments. Costs declining by over 80 per cent since 2014 makes solar + BESS (battery energy storage system) adoption more conducive

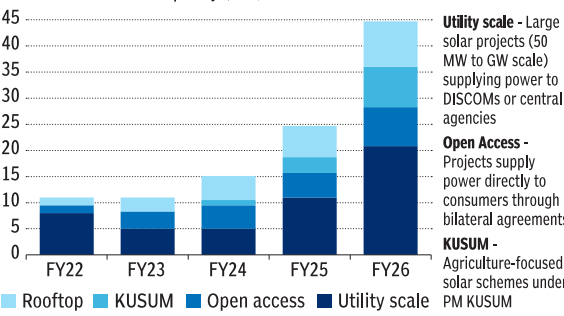
Solar leads the shift in RE installed capacity

NEP 2032: Renewable energy installed capacity targets in GW



Solar installed capacity increases across segments

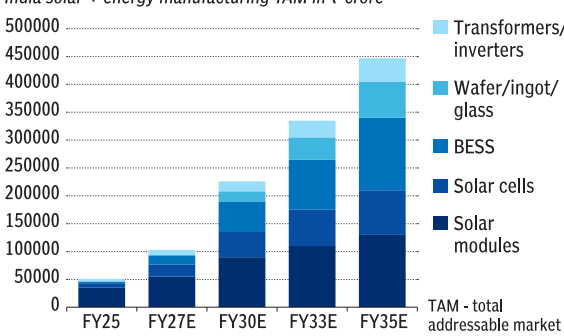
Addition to installed capacity (GW)



Source: India Solar Manufacturing: Demand Update, Supply Reality and Policy Landscape report by Valuequest Investment Advisors

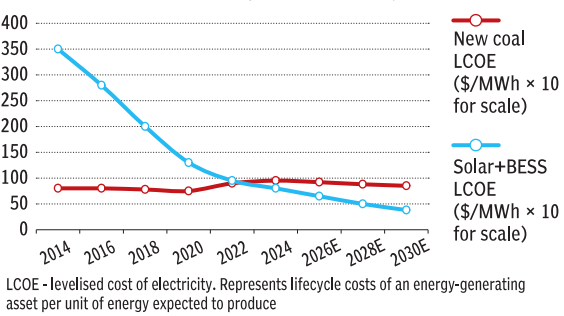
Solar and ancillaries to grow 9x by FY35

India solar + energy manufacturing TAM in ₹ crore



Declining costs accelerate adoption

Solar+BESS LCOE vs Coal LCOE (Global —USD basis)



thehindubusinessline.

TWENTY YEARS AGO TODAY.

May 20, 2006

The bear party continues

The hammering on Dalal Street continued on Friday, with ex changes and broking firms dumping stocks due to lack of margins. Market-unfriendly statements by Left leaders on reforms and taxing of foreign funds helped despatch the bellwether BSE-30 down 452.82 points, or 3.98 per cent, to below 11,000.

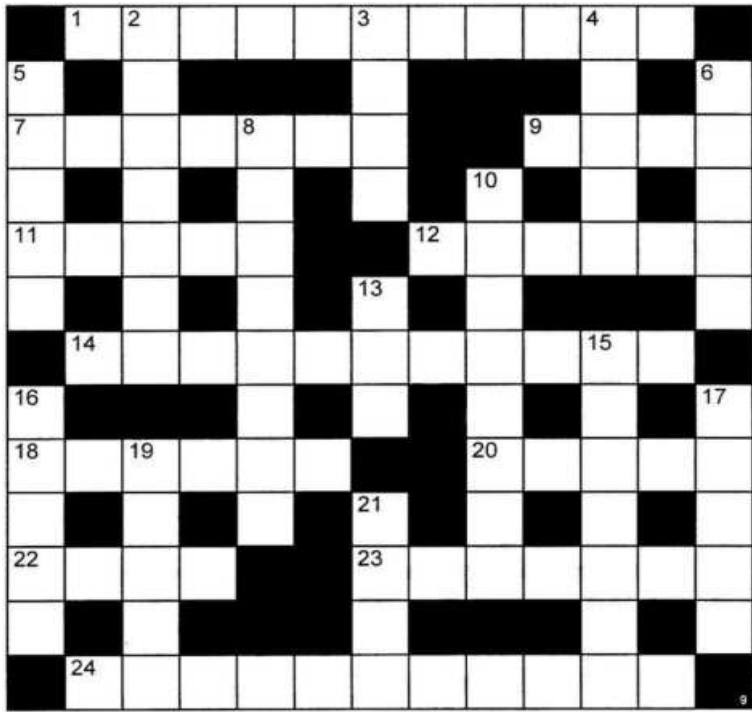
Bring back long-term capital gains tax: CPI(M)

The CPI (M) leader and Rajya Sabha MP, Mr Sitaram Yechury, on Friday demanded reintroduction of long-term capital gains tax on investment in stocks and review of the double taxation avoidance agreement (DTAA) with Mauritius through which most of the FII investments in India are routed. His comments came in view of the more than 1,300 points fall in Sensex during the past two trading sessions.

Birla-Lodha tussle: Calcutta HC appoints 4 administrators

The Birla-Lodha tussle saw dramatic development on Friday. At 3.45 in the afternoon a trial court of the Calcutta High Court appointed a group of administrators for the late Priyamvada Birla’s estate and barred Mr R.S. Lodha from acting as chairman of her company.

BL TWO-WAY CROSSWORD 2683



EASY

ACROSS

- Delightful, affording gratification (11)
- Spring back (7)
- Finished with (4)
- Fly open (5)
- Untilled, uncultivated (6)
- Growing luxuriantly (11)
- Gave lessons (6)
- Poisonous (5)
- Scold, chide (4)
- To aid in distress (7)
- Wilfulness, capriciousness (11)

DOWN

- Generous, broad-minded (7)
- Cancel, annul (4)
- Flat, even (5)
- People of common descent (5)
- Utter slowly and sleepily (5)
- Lies (8)
- Touching: sadly inadequate (8)
- Orchestra space in theatre (3)
- Harmful, hurtful (7)
- Violent weather (5)
- Muffler (5)
- Beyond (prefix) (5)
- Continual enjoyment of a right (4)

NOT SO EASY

ACROSS

- Gratifying way a blue pearl’s set out (11)
- Bounce back to rob nude of it (7)
- In excess of the six deliveries it takes (4)
- Over twenty-one, and about right to explode (5)
- Being left untitled with a wolf left to wander (6)
- Doing well with our fish: ling, it might be (11)
- Was a teacher so soundly strung-up? (6)
- Poisonous use of it cox can sort out (5)
- Assess it right, and a team will forfeit half (4)
- Relief in distress perhaps occurs around the turn (7)
- Irregularity of method, a drawback on the headland (11)

DOWN

- Generous in its transcription of Braille (7)
- Do the reverse for one French party (4)
- It’s even the same upside-down (5)
- Some people bet it could include Rhode Island (5)
- Doctor breaking the law, in a manner of speaking (5)
- Lies one could trust Hun to put about (8)
- Pitiable tip cheat was able to supply (8)
- Mine is the stone in the olive (3)
- It is hurtful to six on Open University for a change (7)
- Bad weather of sort that’s variable on 1st May (5)
- A carpentry joint gets worn around the neck (5)
- It is beyond the marine to be blue (5)
- One on drugs may cause rumpus internally (4)

SOLUTION: BL TWO-WAY CROSSWORD 2682

ACROSS 1. Description 8. Polka 9. Visible 10. Stilton 11. Latch 12. Turbot 14. Crisis 18. Cause 19. Revolve 21. Terrify 23. Trace 24. Making ready

DOWN 1. Deposit 2. Soldier 3. Riant 4. Pavane 5. Insular 6. Nub 7. Beech 13. Obelisk 15. Sultana 16. Scenery 17. Crayon 18. Catch 20. Voter 22. Rum

QUICKLY.

Wealth Company ties up with NSE for EGR segment



Mumbai: The Wealth Company, part of the Pantomath Group, has become the first asset management company to confirm its participation in the Electronic Gold Receipts (EGR) segment launched by NSE. EGRs are exchange-traded instruments backed by physical gold of standardised purity. The Wealth Company's participation is intended to broaden investor access to gold through institutional investment vehicles and contribute to the development of a deep and vibrant EGR ecosystem in India. Ashish Kumar Chauhan, MD and CEO, NSE, said EGRs represent a meaningful step in the financialisation of gold in India, offering investors a transparent, exchange-traded and standardised instrument backed by physical gold. **OUR BUREAU**

Q-Line Biotech to raise ₹214 cr via NSE Emerge IPO

Mumbai: Q-Line Biotech plans to raise ₹214 crore through an initial public offering on NSE Emerge. The company will issue 62,53,200 shares in the price band of ₹326-343 a share. The issue will open from May 21-25. Q-Line Biotech is engaged in the manufacturing and supplying diagnostic reagents, rapid test kits, molecular diagnostics, pathology equipment and related consumables used by hospitals, laboratories across India. It will use net proceeds from the IPO for meeting working capital requirements, repayment of loans and the general corporate purposes. **OUR BUREAU**

Non-discretionary PMS client has right to pledge shares: Regulator

FREE HAND. As beneficial ownership lies with investors, securities can be used for collateral to raise loans

Our Bureau
Mumbai

The Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) has clarified that clients availing themselves of non-discretionary portfolio management services (ND-PMS) can pledge securities held in demat accounts for their own borrowing requirements without violating portfolio management regulations, according to an informal guidance letter issued to Geojit Financial Services.

The clarification, issued on May 18 under the SEBI (Informal Guidance) Scheme, 2025, came in response to a request from the brokerage and wealth management firm Geojit Financial Services on whether securities purchased under an

ND-PMS arrangement could be pledged by clients while continuing to remain part of the portfolio manager's assets under management (AUM).

In its interpretive letter, SEBI said restrictions under Regulation 23(8) of the SEBI (Portfolio Managers) Regulations, 2020 — which prohibit portfolio managers from borrowing funds or securities on behalf of clients — would not prevent ND-PMS clients from independently pledging their securities.

CLIENT OWNERSHIP

The regulator noted that in a non-discretionary PMS structure, investment decisions are taken in accordance with the client's directions and the final decision rests entirely with the client.



ON THE BOOKS. SEBI has clarified that pledged securities can continue to be included in the portfolio manager's AUM and regulatory reporting until the pledge is invoked

Since the securities remain in the beneficial ownership of the client, they can be used as collateral for loans at the client's discretion, SEBI said.

Geojit had sought guidance after a prospective client asked whether securities held under the ND-PMS framework could be pledged

either directly by the client or through instructions routed via the portfolio manager to the custodian.

The company had also sought clarity on whether such pledging would amount to borrowing by the portfolio manager on behalf of the client.

SEBI further clarified that

pledged securities can continue to be included in the portfolio manager's AUM and regulatory reporting until the pledge is invoked. It pointed out that a pledge does not alter beneficial ownership unless the lender invokes the pledge and takes control of the securities.

However, the market regulator refrained from providing specific guidance on disclosures, risk warnings and additional precautions sought by the company, saying the queries were general in nature and did not cite applicable legal provisions.

The clarification is expected to provide greater operational flexibility for PMS clients seeking liquidity against securities held in managed portfolios, while maintaining regulatory clarity for portfolio managers and custodians.

Nifty, Sensex end weak; IT stocks sustain gains

Anupama Ghosh
Mumbai

The markets lurched between gains and losses before ending nearly flat on Tuesday, but the real story was elsewhere — the rupee hitting a new low of 96.61 against the US dollar, crude oil hovering near \$110 a barrel, and an economy heavily dependent on energy imports staring at a storm of macro headwinds.

"The prolonged energy crisis linked to West Asian tensions continues to worsen domestic conditions, with a sharply weaker rupee, rising inflation concerns and elevated crude oil prices collectively reinforcing a broader risk-off environment," said Siddhartha Khemka, Head of Research, Wealth Management, Motilal Oswal Financial Services.

The Sensex closed at 75,200.85, down 114.19 points, while the Nifty shed

31.95 points to 23,618. It was a weekly expiry session, and aggressive derivative unwinding in the final hour erased much of the day's earlier optimism. The one bright spot was IT. The Nifty IT index surged 3.2 per cent, its third consecutive session of gains. A weaker rupee is a direct earnings tailwind for export-heavy tech companies, and institutional investors stepped in with bargain buying after months of heavy corrections.

Realty gained 1.4 per cent, while PSU Bank and Media indices advanced roughly 1 per cent each. Private banking was the primary laggard, capping the market's upside.

However, the Nifty Midcap 100 gained 0.91 per cent and the Smallcap 100 advanced 1.17 per cent.

India VIX declined 5.45 per cent to around 18.55, signalling some cooling of immediate panic, though volatility remains at historically elevated level.

Emkay Global sees Nifty at 29,000 by FY27

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Emkay Global Financial Services maintained a constructive stance on Indian equities, setting a March 2027 Nifty target of 29,000, even as the ongoing West Asia conflict and elevated crude oil prices cast a shadow over near-term prospects.

The brokerage said the Strait of Hormuz has remained shut for eleven weeks following an escalation that began in early April, pushing Brent crude to \$105-110 per barrel. 'This has created under-recoveries of ₹14 per litre for oil marketing companies.



A pump price hike of ₹3 per litre announced by the government addresses only 20 per cent of the gap, with further increases expected unless crude corrects.

Emkay warned that a sustained energy crisis could drag the Nifty to 21,000 — roughly 12.4 per cent below its five-year average price-to-earnings ratio. However, it described any such correc-

tion as transient and an entry opportunity for investors.

EARNINGS MOMENTUM

On the earnings front, the fourth quarter of FY26 has started steadily, with 46 per cent of reported companies beating estimates and 29 per cent missing.

The FY27 Nifty EPS estimate holds at ₹1,230, implying earnings growth of approximately 13 per cent, down only 1.6 per cent since end-March.

The brokerage expects a stronger recovery in FY28, with 14.4 per cent EPS growth projected.

Domestic macro fundamentals remain broadly supportive.

InCred arms invest ₹185 crore in VEM Tech

Our Bureau
Mumbai

InCred Alternative Investments has invested ₹185 crore in Hyderabad-based VEM Technologies Pvt Ltd through InCred Growth Partners Fund-I and InCred Growth Partners Fund-II.

The transaction involves primary growth capital and will support VEM Technologies' expansion plans. The investment comes amid increasing localisation and higher capital expenditure in India's defence manufacturing sector, supported by government policy and rising export opportunities.

SEBI proposes revamping STP framework to cut costs, reduce concentration risk

Press Trust of India
New Delhi

SEBI on Tuesday proposed a revamp of the existing straight-through processing (STP) framework by replacing the current centralised hub-based architecture with a decentralised API-based model to reduce costs, lower latency and improve service delivery for market participants.

In a consultation paper, SEBI proposed doing away with the existing STP centralised hub used for transfer of messages between different STP service providers (SSPs). Instead, message ex-

changes would take place through direct application programming interface (API)-based connectivity between SSPs.

SEAMLESS EXCHANGE

Under the new framework, SSPs catering to different STP users will be required to enable standardised API end points based on agreed protocols and data formats. This would facilitate seamless and secure exchange of messages and data without routing them through a centralised hub.

"This would also enhance scalability and cost-effectiveness of STP framework while supporting the transaction

volumes of institutional trading," SEBI said.

The proposal would not require any change at the level of end users — stock brokers, fund houses and custodians. It would "likely encourage more SSPs to participate, thereby mitigating the concentration risk with single large SSP and improving value added services by SSPs to STP users", it said.

SEBI said an analysis of STP traffic between April 1 and December 31, 2025, showed that 95-99 per cent of all STP messages were routed through a single SSP, creating significant concentration risk. It has invited comments on the proposals till June 9.

Three years on, BSE's Sensex derivatives find their footing

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

Three years after relaunching its Sensex derivatives platform with revised product specifications, the BSE is seeing broader participation across retail and institutional investors in highly competitive equity derivatives market.

BSE relaunched Sensex derivatives in May 2023 with a lower lot size and a revised expiry structure aimed at improving accessibility and liquidity. Since then, the exchange has witnessed steady improvement in turnover, open interest and participant activity, according to an exchange official.

"The growth in Sensex derivatives has been broad-based, with strong participation from all stakeholders including retail and institutional investors," the official said. Individual investors now contribute



roughly 30 per cent of the total trading volume in Sensex derivative contracts.

BSE said institutional participation has also steadily improved over the past three years, helping deepen liquidity alongside improvements in technology infrastructure and product depth.

PRODUCT STRATEGY

The relaunch came at a time when the derivatives market was witnessing rapid expansion, dominated largely by index options trading.

"Product design plays a critical role and voice of customer is the most important in this regard," the official said. BSE initially introduced

Friday expiry contracts, later shifted to Tuesday under SEBI's single-expiry framework and eventually moved expiry to Thursday.

According to the exchange, Thursday expiries have historically seen stronger participation trends and fit well within its broader derivatives strategy.

The dataset viewed by *businessline* showed that the sharpest growth has been in options turnover. Sensex options notional average daily turnover (ADTV) surged from just ₹0.016 lakh crore in May 2023 to ₹268.3 lakh crore by April 2026. Premium turnover also expanded sharply from just ₹2.1 crore to more than ₹33,000 crore.

The exchange also downplayed concerns around the impact of tighter regulatory norms in the derivatives market, saying investor protection and market development should be viewed as complementary objectives.

BROKER'S CALL.

Systematix

TATA CAPITAL (BUY)

Target: ₹400

CMP: ₹302.75

Recent investor interactions have raised concerns around whether the erstwhile Tata Motors Finance franchise continues to operate as a quasi-captive financier post its merger into Tata Capital, potentially implying elevated asset quality risks and structurally weaker profitability in future.

However, our latest channel checks across dealers and fleet operators in Mumbai, Thane and Navi-Mumbai indicate a materially different picture.

Feedback suggests the company is currently prioritising pricing discipline, underwriting quality and operational integration over aggressive market share expansion. Higher lending rates, lower dealer incentives and moderated disbursement growth together reinforce our view that the merged franchise is presently operating with a far more calibrated and profitability-focused approach rather than pursuing volume growth at any cost.

Tata Capital represents a well-diversified NBFC franchise backed by strong parentage from Tata Sons, a broad product suite, extensive distribution, and a Crisil AAA credit rating. While profitability metrics currently trail leading peers, we expect operating leverage, NIM expansion and lower credit costs to drive a gradual improvement in ROAs.

We retain our Buy rating and a target price of ₹400. Our FY27/FY28 PAT estimates are about 4-7 per cent ahead of consensus largely driven by lower credit cost and higher growth, as we believe the street remains conservative despite the company's solid execution track record and clear levers for ROA improvement.

SBI Securities

PRICOL (BUY)

Target: ₹735

CMP: ₹544.90

Pricol reported strong Q4FY26 performance, driven by premiumisation in instrument clusters, robust growth in ACFMS and P3L plastics business. Driver Information Systems (instrument clusters) contributed 60 per cent to the total revenue in FY26. ACFMS (Actuation, Control, Fuel & Mechanical Systems) contributed 20 per cent to the total revenue, growing at 30 per cent in FY26, with a focus on exports growth. The new product line of Disc Brakes is expected to enter mass production in H1FY27, with current capacity of 0.5 million units per annum. P3L (Pricol Precision Polymer Ltd) is witnessing strong demand but facing capacity constraints. Backward integration in displays is likely to commence production in 10-12 months, while the Domino partnership (2W Throttle, Switches) would start contributing to revenue in 18-24 months.

Severe input cost inflation across polymers, Aluminum, Semiconductors and freight significantly affected margins due to partial pass-through to OEMs with a six-month lag. Near-term FY27 outlook remains cautious with limited visibility, slower growth and margin pressure due to macro and geopolitical factors, though the impact is industry-wide.

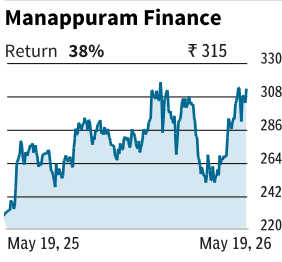
The stock is currently trading at a P/E of 24.0x/16.4x its FY27E/FY28E EPS of ₹23/33.7 respectively. We cut our target price by 10 per cent to ₹735, reflecting the cut in our FY27E earnings growth to account for the margin pressure impact in H1FY27E.

businessline is not responsible for the recommendations sourced from third party brokerages. Reports may be sent to: blmarketwatch@gmail.com

TODAY'S PICK.

Manappuram Finance (₹315.50): BUY

Gurumurthy K
bl. research bureau



The stock is stuck inside a narrow range of ₹292-₹318 for more than two weeks now. It is now near the upper end of this range. The bias is positive to see a bullish breakout above ₹318 eventually.

Such a break can take Manappuram Finance share price up to ₹345-₹350 initially and then to ₹370 eventually. Immediate support is at ₹300.

Below that ₹290-₹285 is the next important support zone. We can expect the stock to sustain above ₹300 itself. Traders can buy Manappuram Finance shares now at ₹315. Accumulate on dips at ₹305.

Keep the stop-loss at ₹282 initially. Trail the stop-loss up to ₹323 as soon as the stock goes up to ₹332. Revise the stop-loss higher to ₹338 and ₹352 when the price touches ₹345 and ₹358 respectively. Exit the long positions at ₹367.

Note: The recommendations are based on technical analysis. There is a risk of loss in trading

Day trading guide

23605 » Nifty 50 Futures					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
23570	23430	23730	23850	Go short on a break below 23570. Keep the stop-loss at 23610	

₹763 » HDFC Bank					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
758	752	768	772	Go short on a rise at 766. Stop-loss can be kept at 769	

₹1194 » Infosys					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
1180	1160	1200	1230	Take fresh longs only above 1200 with a stop-loss at 1190	

₹310 » ITC					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
309	306	312	315	Go short only below 306. Stop-loss can be kept at 307	

₹296 » ONGC					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
293	289	298	302	Go long only on a break above 298 with a stop-loss at 296	

₹1323 » Reliance Ind.					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
1315	1290	1335	1355	Take fresh shorts below 1315. Keep the stop-loss at 1320	

₹947 » SBI					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
944	935	953	958	Go short only below 944. Stop-loss can be placed at 946	

₹2330 » TCS					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
2310	2290	2370	2415	Go long on a bounce from 2310. Keep the stop-loss at 2295	

S1, S2: Support 1 & 2; R1, R2: Resistance 1 & 2.

Nifty 50 Movers					31.95 pts.
	Close(₹)	Pts	PE	WN(%)	
Infosys	1196.90	41.59	16.47	3.87	
TCS	2327.10	9.77	17.03	2.19	
Eternal Ltd.	247.21	9.13	651.82	1.64	
State Bank	946.80	8.51	10.11	3.63	
HCL Tech	1179.40	7.55	19.22	1.15	
Tech Mahindra	1467.10	5.14	29.91	0.86	
Tata Motors PV	361.20	3.68	443.88	0.70	
Adani Enter	2725.00	2.20	35.38	0.72	
SBI Life	1881.40	2.06	76.39	0.78	
PowerGrid Corp	236.50	2.02	17.44	1.25	
Wipro	195.17	1.87	15.43	0.51	
Trent Ltd.	4069.60	1.80	84.04	0.83	
M&M	3092.30	1.68	20.65	2.55	
Max Healthcare	1068.75	1.65	73.28	0.73	
Bajaj Finance	923.55	1.43	29.73	2.28	
HDFC Life	610.40	1.28	68.87	0.61	
NTPC	389.40	1.14	15.21	1.70	
L&T	3921.00	0.82	28.46	4.25	
Dr Reddys Lab	1335.20	0.53	26.80	0.75	
Jio Financial Services Ltd.	233.28	0.46	94.95	0.71	
ITC	310.30	0.32	18.78	2.76	
Axis Bank	1238.30	0.25	14.50	3.28	
Bajaj Auto	1019.00	0.13	26.10	1.04	
Apollo Hosp	8026.00	0.12	61.85	0.75	
NestleIndia	1431.40	-0.05	78.88	0.95	
Bajaj Finserv	1749.80	-0.42	14.24	0.93	
ONGC	296.50	-0.59	8.29	1.06	
Grasim Ind	2935.20	-0.71	21.09	1.03	
Tata Steel	209.29	-0.76	24.00	1.60	
Eicher Motors	6682.50	-0.92	35.24	0.97	
Asian Paints	2600.70	-1.31	63.80	1.09	
Hindalco	1048.30	-1.51	14.65	1.40	
JSW Steel	1285.20	-1.55	12.32	1.11	
Maruti Suzuki	12956.00	-1.72	27.75	1.57	
Shriram Finance Ltd.	927.35	-1.94	21.76	1.20	
Cipla	126.15	-2.01	29.49	0.73	
Int'lGlobeHw	4230.30	-2.24	50.94	0.88	
Coal India	456.95	-2.55	9.06	0.96	
Bharat Elec	422.95	-2.85	51.85	1.40	
AdaniConsumerProduct	1210.90	-2.85	77.47	0.73	
Adani Ports	1762.80	-4.01	31.77	1.20	
Hind Unilever	2323.00	-4.12	49.58	1.83	
UltraTech Cement	11368.00	-4.98	40.91	1.24	
Sun Pharma	1882.30	-5.43	41.23	1.84	
Titan	4102.00	-6.09	71.77	1.56	
Kotak Bank	381.95	-15.81	19.70	2.60	
ICICI Bank	1240.80	-16.06	15.33	1.49	
Bharti Airtel	1913.50	-16.46	34.47	5.42	
Reliance Ind	1322.70	-19.44	18.69	8.25	
HDFC Bank	762.45	-20.69	14.81	10.77	

Standard Chartered to cut over 15% corporate function roles globally

GOING LEAN. Bank says reskilling and redeployment will accompany workforce rejig through 2030

Sindhu Hariharan
Chennai

Standard Chartered (StanChart) on Tuesday said it would cut around 15 per cent of its corporate function roles globally by 2030.

In an internal email to employees, titled “Our Next Phase of Growth,” the global bank said that the transformation is ongoing and the process of change will impact over 15 per cent of corporate functions by 2030.

“Some roles will reduce, others will grow, and new ones will emerge. We expect a reduction in corporate functions roles of more than 15 per cent by 2030. We recognise the uncertainty this creates. We’ll manage this with discipline, through reskilling, redeployment and clear decision making. And where roles do fall away, it reflects changes in the work, not the value of the people. We will handle that with respect and care,” the London-headquartered lender said in the note to employees.



DESI CONNECTION. India hosts 22,000 employees in the bank’s global back-office operations, including 13,000 in Chennai

Per the bank’s investor day presentation, “corporate functions” is defined as non-frontline support services headcount along with independent contractors/consultants. As of end-2025, StanChart employed around 28,000 people in India, of which 22,000 were part of its Global Business Services (GBS) operations. Of the India GBS workforce, around 13,000 employees are based in

Chennai, with Bengaluru and Mumbai being the other key locations.

The bank also has GBS centres in Malaysia, Poland, China and the Philippines.

INTERNAL NOTE

In the internal note, StanChart said it will continue to grow income, improve productivity and increase returns, while investing in the capabilities that keep them competitive.

As of end-2025, StanChart employed around 28,000 people in India, of which 22,000 were part of its Global Business Services (GBS) operations

“And we are positioned where demand is growing, reinforcing our cross-border, affluent and sustainable finance capabilities, supporting clients as they invest, diversify and build across markets,” it said.

RESTRUCTURING PLAN

Standard Chartered did not respond to *businessline* queries on the extent of impact of the restructuring plan on India.

Reuters quoted CEO Bill Winters as telling global reporters that, “It’s not cost-cutting. It’s replacing in some cases lower-value human capital with the financial capital and the investment capital we’re putting in.”

In a global statement put out on Tuesday in connection with its investor event, it reiterated the restructuring plans noting that it aims to “drive productivity improvements to raise income per employee by nearly 20 per cent by 2028, aided by a reduction in corporate functions roles of more than 15 per cent by 2030”.

The global bank also said it will deliver a over 15 per cent RoTE in 2028, a more than 3 percentage point uplift from 2025, and building to nearly 18 per cent in 2030.

STRATEGIC REDRAW

In a recent interview with *businessline*, Judy Hsu, CEO, Wealth and Retail Banking, Standard Chartered, said the bank is strategically redrawing its retail banking approach in India to focus more on affluent customers with cross-border financial needs, rather than the mass retail segment.

Rupee may drift to 97

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

The rupee remained under pressure last week, declining nearly 1 per cent to close at 96.53 against the dollar on Tuesday. During the session, the local currency slipped to a fresh record low of 96.61, extending its weak run in 2026 to about 7.5 per cent.

WEEKLY RUPEE VIEW.

Persistent foreign outflows continue to weigh on the rupee. Per NSDL data, net FPI outflows stood at about \$842 million over the past week, taking the total outflows to \$1.99 billion in May and \$22.2 billion so far in 2026. India’s trade deficit widened to \$28.38 billion in April, compared with \$20.67 billion in March, indicating elevated import demand, particularly amid high crude oil prices.

Global factors have further strengthened the dollar. The US 10-year Treasury yield climbed to a one-year high of 4.63 per cent early this week, reinforcing expectations that the Federal Reserve may not have room to cut interest rates anytime soon. This has supported the dollar and added pressure on

emerging market currencies, including the rupee.

Geopolitical tensions involving Iran continue to keep markets on edge. Although US President Donald Trump said a planned strike on Iran has been temporarily deferred to allow diplomacy, uncertainty persists as negotiations remain fragile.

Meanwhile, Brent crude futures gained nearly 8 per cent last week and continue to trade around \$110/barrel. While India’s crude basket has eased from April’s \$114.48/barrel to \$107.3/barrel in May, prolonged elevated prices could continue to strain the rupee by increasing import costs and widening the trade imbalance.

NO RELIEF RALLY

After hitting a fresh all-time low of 96.61 on Tuesday, the rupee recovered marginally to close at 96.53. However, the price action indicates that the downturn remains intact, with no meaningful signs of a relief rally yet.

As things stand, the likelihood of further weakness remains high. The nearest support levels are seen at 96.80 and 97. On the other hand, if the local currency recovers from the current level, it could face resistance at 96.25 and then at 96. Given the prevailing sentiment and

broad trend, a sustained move above 96 appears unlikely for now. Renewed strength in the dollar over the past week has added further pressure on the rupee. Notably, even when the greenback was largely flat earlier, the Indian currency continued to weaken, highlighting the underlying fragility in the rupee. The dollar index, currently trading around 99.20, appears to have regained momentum and could rise further towards 100 and 100.40 in the near term. Such a move may drag the rupee quickly towards the 97 mark.

Only a decline in the dollar index below 97.50 could offer some breathing space for the rupee.

However, at the moment, such a scenario appears less likely.

BEARISH OUTLOOK

Both fundamentals and technical indicators continue to point towards weakness in the rupee. Given the sustained foreign outflows, elevated crude oil prices and strengthening dollar, the ongoing downtrend is likely to drag the local currency towards 97 in the near term. Any recovery, if at all, is likely to remain limited unless the dollar index softens meaningfully.

Star Health eyes ₹24,000 cr premium in FY27, launches new product ‘Value Plus’

Sindhu Hariharan
Chennai

Standalone health insurer Star Health Insurance is targeting a growth of close to 18 per cent in terms of its top-line growth in FY27 driven by a ramp-up in agents’ network and greater demand on the back of GST rate cut.

“Last year we did ₹20,400 crore of gross written premium, and this year we hope to do around ₹24,000 crores... Our new business growth has gone up by 2x after the waiver of GST and it’s sticky,” Anand Roy, MD & CEO, Star Health Insurance Company, told *businessline*. “With the GST relief given by the Government of India, the whole sector has seen a significant uptick in growth, including Star Health,” he added.

GOOD TRACTION

The insurer is also seeing good traction in existing customers, who are now renewing their policies better due to the GST cut. While last year their average retention was around 87 per cent on volume basis, this year it has gone up to 88-89 per cent, Roy said. “We have more than 850,000 agents who are partnered with us. We add close to 100,000 agents every year,” he added.

Marking 20 years of its foundation, the company also announced the launch of an affordable new product targeted to bring increased health protection to those in tier 2-3-4 cities.

Titled, ‘Value Plus’, the



Anand Roy, MD & CEO, Star Health Insurance Company Ltd BUJOY GHOSH

product customises high sum-insured covers from ₹7.5 lakh to ₹25 lakh at nearly 20 per cent lower premiums. “All the basic requirements of the proper health insurance is covered in this [product]. We have tied up with a network of around 11,000 hospitals across the tier 2/3/4 locations, and based on that we are able to give a discounted premium,” he said.

The company is also leveraging AI to improve efficiency and reduce operating cost. “Almost 25 per cent of our claims are being processed through our AI models in our claim services. That’s resulting in better turnaround times, error-free processing, and better fraud detection as well,” he said.

With regard to claims payout, the CEO said they paid out ₹12,000 crore in claims last year, and claims ratio (premium collected versus claims paid) was close to 69 per cent. “96 per cent of our claims are paid in less than three hours; we have to get to 100 per cent,” he said.

Hatsun Agro Product Q4 PAT up 18.6% at ₹51 crore

Our Bureau
Chennai

Hatsun Agro Product (HAP) reported a 18.6 per cent increase in net profit after tax (PAT) at ₹51 crore for the quarter ending March 2026, against ₹43 crore for the same quarter last year.

Revenue from operations during the quarter stood at ₹2,580 crore, up 14.6 per cent from the ₹2,251 crore in Q4FY25.

For the full year FY26, PAT came in at ₹356 crore (₹279 crore). Revenue from operations for FY26 stood at ₹9,959 crore (₹8,699 crore).

“Our focus on operational efficiency has successfully reduced our debt-to-equity ratio from 1.44 in FY 2023-24 to 0.68 in FY 2025-26 in two years despite significant investments and also strategic acquisition. This strengthened financial position provides the company with the flexibility to invest in future projects while continuing to reward our shareholders,” said RG Chandramogan, Chairman, Hatsun Agro Product.

INDUSTRY OUTLIER

He added that Hatsun remains an industry outlier, delivering superior operating profits with efficiency.

“This success is driven by our market-leading consumer brands, namely, Arun, ibaco, Arokya, Hatsun, HAP Daily and Milky Moo,” he added.

Hatsun Agro Product shares on NSE closed at ₹946.90 on Tuesday, up ₹25.15 or 2.73 per cent from the previous day’s close.

RBI seeks more granular risk, capital disclosures from banks

Our Bureau
Mumbai

The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) has proposed a sharper disclosure regime for banks under the Basel III framework, with the aim to enhance transparency and strengthen market discipline through more detailed and standardised reporting of financial and risk indicators.

In a consultation paper on revised Pillar 3 disclosure norms issued on Tuesday, the central bank said lenders would be required to publish granular information every

quarter on capital adequacy, liquidity, leverage and risk exposure in a uniform format. The proposed framework will cover key metrics such as Common Equity Tier 1 (CET1) capital, total capital ratio, risk-weighted assets (RWAs), leverage ratio, liquidity coverage ratio (LCR) and net stable funding ratio (NSFR).

REVISED FRAMEWORK

Banks will also have to provide narrative explanations for major changes in these parameters from one reporting period to another. The RBI said the revised

framework is aimed at improving the quality and consistency of disclosures made by banks, enabling investors and market participants to better assess the financial strength and risk profile of lenders. Under the proposal, banks must create a dedicated “Regulatory Disclosure Section” on their websites to

host all Pillar 3 disclosures. They will also be required to maintain an archive of past disclosure reports for ten years and Pillar 3 disclosures should be published simultaneously with a bank’s financial results for the relevant period. If no financial statements are issued for a particular re-

porting cycle, the disclosures must still be released as soon as practicable. The draft norms also outline qualitative disclosure requirements, asking banks to explain their processes for identifying, measuring and managing risks, alongside quantitative data. However, the RBI has al-

lowed some flexibility by permitting banks to withhold disclosures considered immaterial or not meaningful to users.

It has invited stakeholder comments by June 2. The final guidelines are proposed to come into effect from the quarter ending September 30, 2026.

कोचीन शिपयार्ड लिमिटेड
COCHIN SHIPYARD LIMITED

Registered Office: Administrative Building, Cochin Shipyard Premises, Perumanoor, Kochi – 682015, Ph: 0484 2501306, Email: secretary@cochinshipyard.in, Website: www.cochinshipyard.in CIN: L63032KL1972G0I002414

NOTICE TO SHAREHOLDERS
TRANSFER OF EQUITY SHARES OF THE COMPANY TO INVESTOR EDUCATION AND PROTECTION FUND (IEPF) AUTHORITY

Notice is hereby given to the shareholders of Cochin Shipyard Limited (“the Company”) that pursuant to the provisions of Section 124(6) of the Companies Act, 2013 read with the Investor Education and Protection Fund Authority (Accounting, Audit, Transfer and Refund) Rules, 2016, (“the Rules”), as amended from time to time, the Company is required to transfer the Equity Shares on which dividend has not been claimed for seven consecutive years or more in the name of the Investor Education and Protection Fund (“IEPF”). The Final Dividend declared for the Financial Year 2018-19, which remains unclaimed for a period of seven years will be credited to the IEPF within 30 days from the due date of September 13, 2026. The corresponding shares on which dividends remain unclaimed for seven consecutive years will also be transferred to the Demat Account of the IEPF Authority.

As per the Rules, individual notices have been sent on May 19, 2026 to the shareholders whose shares are liable for transfer to IEPF Account and the details of such shareholders is also made available in the “INVESTORS” section of the Company’s website (www.cochinshipyard.in) under the tab titled “Dividend”.

The concerned shareholders are requested to claim the unpaid dividend by forwarding a request letter along with the client master list having the updated bank account details (including the IFS code) to which the said dividend has to be credited, to the Company’s Registrar and Transfer Agent MUFG Intime India Private Limited (formerly Link Intime India Private Limited), Surya 35, Mayflower Avenue, Behind Senthil Nagar, Sowripalayam Road, Coimbatore - 641028, Tel No.: +91 (422) 2314792, 4958995 E-mail: iepf.shares@in.mfpm.mufig.com.

The Unclaimed Final Dividend for the Financial Year 2018-19 shall be claimed on or before September 06, 2026, failing which the said dividend along with the corresponding shares shall be transferred to IEPF at an appropriate date without any further notice and no claims thereafter shall lie against the Company. It may be noted that shareholders can claim the dividend and shares from the IEPF Authority by making an online application in the prescribed Form IEPF 5 available on the website www.iepf.gov.in.

For any information/clarifications on this matter, shareholders are requested to contact the Company’s RTA, MUFG Intime India Pvt. Ltd., at the address mentioned above.

The Shareholders may also note that the Company, under the guidance of the IEPF Authority, has launched the Second 100-day special outreach initiative titled “Saksham Niveshak” from April 01, 2026 to July 09, 2026. The initiative aims to assist shareholders in updating KYC details, including bank account mandates, nominee registration and contact information (email, mobile number, address), and in claiming unpaid/unclaimed dividends promptly to prevent transfer of dividends/shares to IEPF. Further details are available in the “INVESTORS” section of the Company’s website (www.cochinshipyard.in).

For Cochin Shipyard Limited
Sd/-
Syamkamal N
Company Secretary

Kochi
May 19, 2026

KERALA FEEDS LTD.
(A Govt. of Kerala undertaking)
Kallattumkara, Thrissur Dist. Pin: 680 683
Phone: 0480-2713550
E-mail: purchase.kf@kerala.gov.in
Website: www.keralafeeds.com

E - TENDER FOR SUPPLY OF CONVEYORS

Tender ID:2026_KFL_851629_1 18-05-2026

E-tender is invited for the above from established Manufacturer / Authorized dealer. For more details please visit Kerala Government E-tender portal www.etenders.kerala.gov.in. (Sd/-) Managing Director

KERALA BOOKS AND PUBLICATIONS SOCIETY
(An undertaking of the Government of Kerala)
KAKKANAD P. O, KOCHI 682 030, KERALA
Website : www.keralabooks.org
E-mail : books.kbps@gmail.com

Re - e -Tender Notice

No. P1-3554/2026/1904 Date:08.05.2026

e-Tender Notice

e-Tenders are invited for the supply, installation, testing and commissioning of Thermal Plate Processor – 1 no. Further details can be availed from our website www.kbps.kerala.gov.in or over phone 0484-2422343/ 9995412786. Sd/- Managing Director

KERALA BOOKS AND PUBLICATIONS SOCIETY
(An undertaking of the Government of Kerala)
KAKKANAD P. O, KOCHI 682 030, KERALA
Website : www.keralabooks.org
mail : books.kbps@gmail.com

Re - e -Tender Notice

P2-3426/LT/DIST/2026/2020 Date: 13.05.2026

Re e-tenders are invited from goods transport vehicle owners for the Transportation of Lottery Tickets to Thrissuranthapuram and Various District Tourist offices in Kerala. For more details, please contact over phone 0484-2422343, 9995412786, 9288001411 or visit our web site www.kbps.kerala.gov.in. Sd/-, Managing Director

MALABAR CEMENTS LIMITED
(A Government of Kerala Undertaking)
An ISO 9001:2015, 14001:2015 Company, Walayar Post, Palakkad - Kerala
Email: bulkclm@malabarceements.com / material@malabarceements.com

TENDER NOTICE

Visit www.etenders.kerala.gov.in for Online Submission of Bids for:

❖ Transportation of dry fly ash from NLC India Ltd. Cuddalore dist./NTPL Tuticorin to MCL. ❖ Supply of 5,000 MT Clinker ON FOR Walayar basis. ❖ Supply of 5,000 MT Clinker ON FOR CGU, Pallippuram, Cherthala, Alappuzha, Kerala. ❖ Collection and transportation of packed cement within 250km radius from CGU, Pallipuram, Cherthala to various locations in Kerala through trucks. ❖ Supply of 10,000 MT High Grade Sweetener Limestone to MCL ON FOR Walayar Basis. ❖ Supply of Special Steel Cord Belt 720MM for Belt Bucket Elevator. ❖ Supply of Grease for Girth Gear ❖ Supply of Explosives. Sd/-, MANAGING DIRECTOR

Invest Karnataka Forum
(A Government of Karnataka Organisation)
No.49, 3rd Floor (East Wing), Khanija Bhavan, D.Devaraj Urs Road, (Race Course Road), Bengaluru-560 001. Ph: 91-080-2220633/22205333.
No. IKF/AO/14/KP-Tender/2026-27

Tender for Selection of Knowledge Partner for Investment Attraction in Karnataka

(Through E-Procurement only)

Invest Karnataka Forum (IKF), a company registered under Section 8 of Companies Act 2013 is engaged in promotion of investments in industry and service sector in the State of Karnataka. IKF intends to avail the services of a Knowledge Partner for Investment Attraction in Karnataka. IKF invites Proposals for selection of the proposed Knowledge Partner. Tender document containing details of eligibility criteria, scope of work and other terms and conditions may be obtained from the website of e-procurement Department, Government of Karnataka. The last date for submission of Tenders at <http://kppp.karnataka.gov.in> is **12.06.2026, at 4:00 pm**. IKF reserves the right to reject any or all Proposals without assigning any reason, whatsoever. Sd/- Chief Executive Officer, IKF

CRAFTSMAN AUTOMATION LIMITED
(CIN: L28991TZ1986PLC001816)
Registered Office: 123/4, Sangothipalayam Road, Arasur Post, Coimbatore - 641407. Web: www.craftsmanautomation.com. Email: investor@craftsmanautomation.com

NOTICE OF EXTRAORDINARY GENERAL MEETING

NOTICE is hereby given that the Extraordinary General Meeting (“EGM”) of the Members of Craftsman Automation Limited (“the Company”) will be held through Video Conference (“VC”) / Other Audio-Visual Means (“OAVM”) on **Saturday, the 13th June, 2026 at 11.00 A.M.** IST in compliance with all the applicable provisions of the Companies Act, 2013 and the Rules made thereunder and the Securities and Exchange Board of India (“SEBI”) (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) (“LODR”) Regulations, 2015, read with the Circulars issued by the SEBI (the latest circular dated 3rd October, 2024) and the Ministry of Corporate Affairs (“MCA”) from time to time (the latest circular dated 22nd September, 2025) (“Circulars”) to transact the business as set forth in the Notice calling the EGM.

In compliance with the above-mentioned MCA Circulars and SEBI Circulars, the Notice of the EGM is being sent on 19th May, 2026 only through electronic mode, to all the Members whose e-mail addresses are registered with the CDSL / NSDL (Depositories) or Company / Registrar & Share Transfer Agent (“RTA”) viz. MUFG Intime India Private Limited (formerly known as Link Intime India Private Limited) and is also available on the Company’s website at www.craftsmanautomation.com and on the website of CDSL at www.evotingindia.com. The same is also displayed on the website of the Stock Exchanges viz. BSE Limited at www.bseindia.com and National Stock Exchange of India Limited at www.nseindia.com.

Members can attend and participate in the EGM through the VC/OAVM facility only. The instructions for joining the EGM electronically are provided in the Notice of the EGM. Members attending the meeting through VC/OAVM shall be counted for the purpose of reckoning the quorum under Section 103 of the Companies Act, 2013. The facility for the appointment of a proxy will not be available for the EGM.

The Company is pleased to provide electronic voting facility to all its Members to exercise their vote by electronic means on all resolutions set forth in the Notice of the EGM through the platform provided by Central Depository Services India Limited (CDSL). Members have the option to cast their vote on all of the resolutions using remote e-voting facility or e-voting during the EGM. Detailed procedure for remote e-voting / e-voting during the EGM is provided in the notes of the notice of the EGM.

Members are requested to note the following:

- Only those Members, whose names are recorded in Register of Members or in Register of Beneficial Owners (in case of electronic shareholding) maintained by Depositories as on the cut-off date i.e., Saturday, the 6th June, 2026 will be entitled to avail the facility of remote e-voting, participation at the EGM and voting during the EGM;
- In case a person has become a Member of the Company after dispatch of the EGM notice but on or before the cut-off date for e-voting, he/she may obtain the credentials in the manner as mentioned in the notice of EGM;
- Remote E-voting period shall commence on Wednesday, the 10th June, 2026 at 9.00 A.M. (IST) and ends on Friday, the 12th June, 2026 at 5.00 P.M. (IST). The e-voting mode shall be disabled by CDSL thereafter;
- Once the vote on a resolution is cast by the Member, the Member shall not be allowed to change it subsequently;
- The Members who have cast their vote by remote e-voting prior to the EGM may also attend / participate in the EGM through VC / OAVM but shall not be entitled to cast their vote again;
- Those Members, who will be present in the EGM through VC / OAVM facility and have not cast their vote on the resolution through remote e-voting are otherwise not barred from doing so, shall be eligible to vote through e-voting system during the EGM;
- For all queries or issues regarding attending the EGM & e-voting from the CDSL e-Voting System, you can write to helpdesk.evoting@cdslindia.com or contact at toll free no. 1800 2109911;
- All grievances connected with the facility for voting by electronic means may be addressed to Mr. Rakesh Dalvi, Assistant Vice President, (CDSL) Central Depository Services (India) Limited, A Wing, 25th Floor, Marathon Futrex, Mafatal Mill Compounds, N.M.Joshi Marg, Lower Panel (East), Mumbai - 400013 or send an email to helpdesk.evoting@cdslindia.com or call toll free no. 1800 21 09911.

The Board of Directors of the Company have appointed Dr. C.V.Madhusudhanan, Partner, failing him Mr. V.R. Sankaranarayanan, Partner of M/s. KSR & Co Company Secretaries LLP, Coimbatore, Practicing Company Secretaries as the Scrutinizer to scrutinize the remote e-voting process and voting through the electronic voting system at the EGM in a fair and transparent manner.

The result declared along with the Scrutinizer’s Report will be placed on the Company’s website www.craftsmanautomation.com and on the website of CDSL for e-voting www.evotingindia.com immediately after the declaration of result and the same will be communicated to BSE Limited and the National Stock Exchange of India Limited. Members are requested to carefully read all the notes set out in the notice of the EGM and in particular, instructions for joining the EGM, manner of casting vote through remote e-voting or voting during the EGM.

By Order of the Board
for Craftsman Automation Limited
Sd/-
Shaishad Aduvanni
Company Secretary

Date: 19th May, 2026
Place: Coimbatore

CM YK 9 A CH-CE



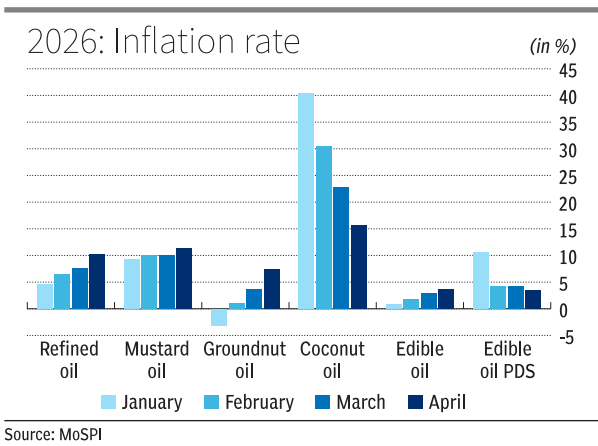
Mumbai: Mahindra & Mahindra and DBS Bank India have signed a MoU to launch India's first sustainability-linked dealer financing programme in the automotive sector, offering authorised Mahindra dealers preferential interest rates on vehicle loans tied to their environmental performance. Under the programme, dealers will be ranked against a set of ESG parameters drawn from Mahindra's Green Dealership Programme. OUR BUREAU

Mumbai: AU Small Finance Bank (AU SFB) on Tuesday announced a collaboration with Intellect Design Arena to deploy the latter's Purple Fabric platform across its operations, marking one of the more significant enterprise AI adoption moves by an Indian bank this year. As an early deployment, AU SFB will roll out PF Credit, AI-powered decision engines designed to automate credit assessments and speed up lending decisions by analysing customer data in real time. **OUR BUREAU**

Shishir Sinha
Prabhudatta Mishra
New Delhi

Noting that edible oil im-

“Indonesia is diverting about 50 per cent of its palm



There is no relief in sight, Ghanshyam Khandelwal, Chairman at BL Agro, said. Going forward, prices are ex-

Sudhakar Desai, President, Indian Vegetable Oil

“Whenever the times are tough, whenever we have any

SEIZE OPPORTUNITY

"In such a situation, we do not need to panic," Goyal said, adding the West Asia crisis and emerging techno-



Commerce and Industry
Minister Piyush Goyal ANI

logies, such as AI, bring opportunities for the Indian industry to seize. He also urged industry to adopt greater efficiency and reduce waste by learning from global best practices, including Japan-

Referring to suggestions received during discussions with industry representatives, he said that the government is examining the possibility of establishing a single body at industrial parks to function as a one-stop shop for all Central and State approvals. He also urged greater engagement from the private sector in improving government systems, while expressing concern that the national single-window system had not re-

proactively leverage upcoming FTAs by exploring new markets and increasing global engagement even before the agreements formally come into effect, he said.

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

India remains Apollo's principal growth engine. Standalone revenue rose 14.3 per cent to ₹5240 crore in the March quarter, while EBITDA margins expanded

Despite the price hikes, demand has remained resilient. April volumes were "equally strong," Kumar said, indicating that customers have so far absorbed higher prices without materially affecting volumes.

Our Bureau
Kolkata

"We acquired a plant, Ramsarup Industries, from NCLT. We are planning to set up a railway coaches manufacturing facility and a speciality steel manufactur-

The company, which is in the process of business and products diversification, is eagerly waiting for the new

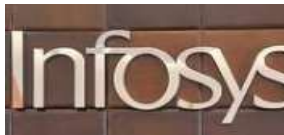


“We are waiting for the new industrial policies. I am very optimistic that we will get a lot of support from the Central government as well.”

Our Bureau
Mumbai

The company posted revenue of \$250.1 million in Q4 FY26 supported by growth in bus ticketing and other business. While the actual rise in revenue was 1.9 per cent, growth measured constant currency terms was 6.7 per cent.

Sanjana B
Bengaluru



For PL5 employees, payouts ranged from 79 per cent for top performers to 65 per cent at the lower end, while employees in the commendable category received 72 per cent. At the PL6 level, "outstanding" performers re-

The IT giant reported a steady operational performance in Q4 FY26, with revenue rising 13.4 per cent to ₹46,402 crore, or 4.1 per cent in constant currency terms. Net profit for the quarter rose 20.9 per cent to ₹8,501 crore. The company has guided for FY27 revenue growth of 1.5-3.5 per cent, while the operating margin for the quarter stood at 21 per cent.

Our Bureau



ROAD AHEAD
Built over more than a decade, IBF has established itself as one of the highest quality producers of processed frozen potato products globally, combining large-scale farming networks, modern, automated processing infrastructure and rigorous food safety and

The business is in the process of increasing its processing capacity significantly over the next six months with a new modern manufacturing facility in Gujarat, positioning IBF to further strengthen its presence across global markets.

Advent's investment will help accelerate IBF's next

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

In the note, Munjal credited Jain with building two key businesses within the Unacademy group. He high-

Jain joined Unacademy in 2020 after the edtech firm acquired his start-up OpenTalk.

Our Bureau
Mumbai



Jensen Huang, Founder,
President and CEO of Nvidia

“Between the amount of computation and the amount of product demand use going up, we’ve now arrived at the era of useful AI.”

To address this, Huang talked about working with Dell Technologies to launch a broad set of advancements

“With the advent of qgentics AI, every organisation now faces the same challenge to turn intelligence into impact at speed or become obsolete,” said Dell.

UP's Expressways: The Growth Engine of Trillion \$ Economy

SMARTER ROADS • STRONGER ECONOMY • BRIGHTER FUTURE

From having just two expressways in 2017 to developing an extensive network of 22, Uttar Pradesh has witnessed a remarkable transformation in its infrastructure landscape. Enhanced connectivity, faster mobility, and integrated industrial corridors are not only redefining development across the State, but also accelerating Uttar Pradesh's journey towards becoming a \$1 trillion economy.

“The foundation stone laid by the Prime Minister in December 2021 has now taken concrete shape. This 594-kilometre-long expressway will serve as a major medium for the progress of farmers, employment for youth, preservation of faith and culture and the prosperity of Uttar Pradesh.

- Yogi Adityanath
Chief Minister, Uttar Pradesh

“In Uttar Pradesh today, not only are expressways being built, but the overall development of the state is progressing at an even faster pace.

- Narendra Modi
Prime Minister

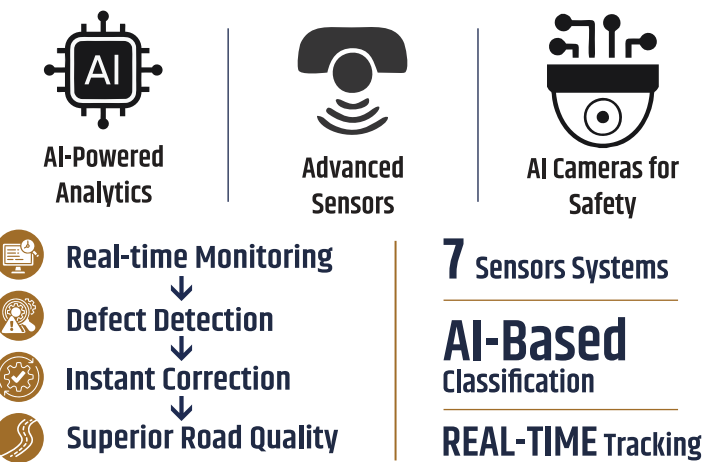
SMART EXPRESSWAYS: THE NEXT EVOLUTION

Under the leadership of Yogi Adityanath, Uttar Pradesh has adopted AI and Swiss sensor technology to ensure the quality, safety and durability of its expressways.

- ✓ Sensor-based scanning during construction
- ✓ Seven accelerometer sensors capture road surface data
- ✓ AI-based analysis classifies quality as Excellent, Good, or Poor
- ✓ AI cameras detect overspeeding and wrong-lane driving
- ✓ Real-time monitoring ensures safer and more comfortable travel

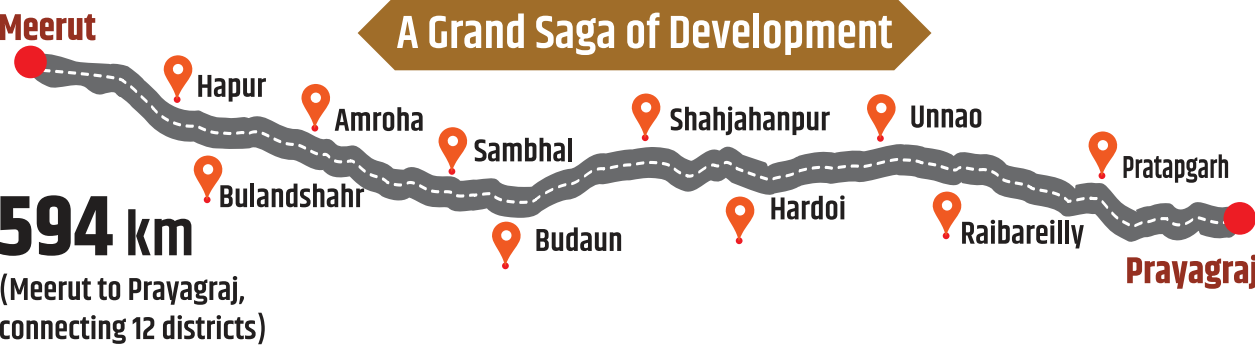


AI + SWISS TECHNOLOGY IN ACTION



THE GANGA EXPRESSWAY

A Grand Saga of Development



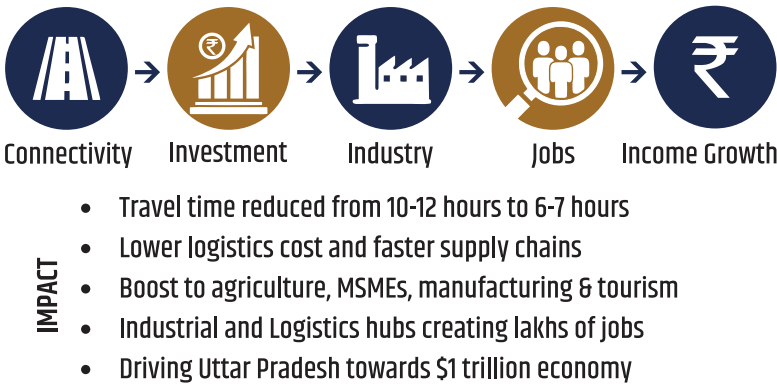
- 594 KM** Length
- 6 Lanes** (expandable to 8 lanes)
- 12** Districts Covered
- ₹36,000+ Cr** Estimated Cost
- PPP Model** Public-Private Partnership

Key Milestones

- 2018-19:** DPR, Land Identification & Techno-economic Studies
- 2020:** Environmental Clearances & Financial Structuring
- 2021:** Foundation Stone Laid (Dec 18, 2021) by PM Modi
- 2026:** Inaugurated (April 29, 2026) by PM Modi

ENGINE OF ECONOMIC TRANSFORMATION

The Expressway Economic Multiplier:



IMLC: HIGH-INCENTIVE INDUSTRIAL CORRIDOR

- Up to 42% Capital Subsidy on Eligible Capex
- 100% Net SGST reimbursement up to 300% of ECI
- Up to 80% Land Subsidy (front-end)
- 100% Exemption on Stamp Duty
- 100% Electricity Duty Exemption for 5 Years
- Up to ₹2.5 Cr in Incentives for Green Technology
- Up to ₹10 Crore Grant for R&D and Innovation
- Additional 30% Top-up under the GoI PLI Scheme

SINGLE WINDOW • SIMPLE • TRANSPARENT



SPIRITUAL, CULTURAL & ECO-TOURISM CORRIDOR

Connecting pilgrimage, heritage and eco-tourism destinations across western, central and eastern Uttar Pradesh:

- HASTINAPUR** (Pandaveshwarnath Temple)
- SAMBHAL** (Kalki Temple)
- BUDAUN** (Zari Zardozi)
- HARDOI** (Handloom)
- PRAYAGRAJ** (Sangam and Tourism Hub)
- UNNAO** (CSA Bird Sanctuary, Nawabganj)



EXPRESSWAY STATE (UTTAR PRADESH)

- 22** Expressways (Operational + Under Construction + Proposed)
- UP Holds the largest share of India's expressway network.
- 27** Industrial Nodes across 26 districts
- 5,300+** Hectares Identified for Industrial Development

OUR GROWING EXPRESSWAY NETWORK

- OPERATIONAL:**
 - Ganga Expressway
 - Purvanchal Expressway
 - Bundelkhand Expressway
 - Agra-Lucknow Expressway
 - Yamuna Expressway
- PROPOSED:**
 - Delhi-Meerut Expressway
 - Goarakhpur Link Expressway
 - Noida-Greater Noida Expressway
 - Delhi-Saharanpur-Dehradun Expressway (Economic Corridor)
 - Chitrakoot Link Expressway
 - Farrukhabad Link Expressway
 - Jewar-Ganga Link Expressway
 - Vindhya Expressway
 - Vindhya-Purvanchal Link Expressway



BETTER CONNECTIVITY. BETTER UTTAR PRADESH. BETTER INDIA.

Expressways are no longer merely roads. They have become lifelines of growth, driving investment, creating opportunities, and paving the way towards a \$1 trillion economy.

QUICKLY.

SWISS to start Bengaluru to Zurich non-stop flights



Bengaluru: SWISS International Airlines has introduced non-stop flights between Zurich and Bengaluru. These flights will start in October of this year and operate five days a week. It bypasses layover stops in European cities like Frankfurt and Munich. This comes after the airline introduced twice daily flights from Delhi to Zurich in March and said it is looking to expand in south India. **OUR BUREAU**

flyadeal to fly daily from Riyadh to Hyderabad

New Delhi: Saudi Arabia’s no-frills airline flyadeal will start daily flights between Riyadh and Hyderabad from July 1, marking the commencement of its services to India. The flights between Riyadh and Hyderabad will be operated with A320 neo aircraft having 186 economy class seats, the carrier said. **PTI**

GCCs face challenges adapting to new work-from-home policies

FACING A DILEMMA. Almost all of them are in hybrid mode, and recalibrating this model could be difficult

KV Kurmanath
Hyderabad

Even as Prime Minister Narendra Modi’s recent advisory to organisations to consider switching to work from home (WFH) sparked the debate, global capability centres (GCCs), which are already in a hybrid mode, might find it difficult to further calibrate their day-to-day operations to allow their staff to work for more days from home.

Almost all of them are already in hybrid mode, with office work ranging from two to four days, optimising resources to the core. Recalibrating this model could well be a challenge for them.

This new space in the IT industry is attracting attention as India emerges as a global hub for GCCs. It now employs 2.3 million professionals or 40 per cent of the country’s 6 million IT work-

force. “About 99 per cent of GCCs have already established hybrid work norms. With great nudges and engagement, they have reached a two- or three-day work from office culture after a three-year struggle,” Kamal Karanth, CoFounder of Xpheno a specialist staffing company, told *businessline*.

ATTRITION RATE “The real challenge comes here. The average attrition rate in GCCs is pegged at 12 per cent. If you look at the bottom of the pyramid, this goes up to 18 per cent thanks to the rapid growth in the greenfield GCCs. This means that they are constantly dealing with a large part of their workforce that is learning or moving. It would be difficult for them to handle this if they increase WFH days,” he said.

“When one-fourth of the organisation is on the move, increasing the number of remote working days will



JOB CONSTRAINTS. Remote work may not be ideal for a new setup in India, an expert said

hamper the organisation’s productivity,” he said.

Nearly one-fourth of the GCCs in the country were established only in the last 2-3 years, with some becoming critical bottlenecks in the innovation backbone of their respective parent companies. Some of them are being referred to as global innovation centres, indicating that they are well beyond the description of a GCC.

“For now, we are already working on a hybrid model. We are closely monitoring how the fellow GCCs are re-

sponding (to the Prime Minister’s suggestion). We will take a call, if need be,” a top executive of a GCC for a US-based financial services company.

GLOBAL CONTEXT

The new GCCs need to establish themselves within their global context and start delivering. With the new set of leaders and workforce from various organisations they have hired, they need to congregate more often to align on processes and work culture. “Remote work may

not be ideal for a brand new setup in India, with millions of dollars invested thousands of miles away from headquarters,” Karanth said.

JLR (Jaguar Land Rover) Technology & Business Services India, which is already in a hybrid mode, sees no significant change in their strategy.

EMPLOYEE WELLBEING

“We are already following a hybrid model. It has been working well for both the business and our employees so far,” Lalitha Indrakanti, CEO, JLR TBSI, said. “As an organisation, we always evaluate our ways of working, keeping in mind business requirements, employee wellbeing and broader external factors. At this point, we do not foresee any significant change in our current approach and will continue with our hybrid working model that works best for our operations and teams,” she said.

Chemists go on 24-hour strike; pharmacies run by govt to remain open

PT Jyothi Datta
Mumbai

Over 12 lakh chemists across the country will down shutters for a day, starting midnight on Tuesday, representatives with an apex chemist body confirmed, pointing to concerns of “deep discounts” extended by online pharmacies, among other things.

Members of the All India Organisation of Chemists and Druggists (AIOCD) will hold protests across the country in their regions and convey their grievances to the respective authorities, AIOCD President JS Shinde told *businessline*.

In Mumbai, for example, 1,000 chemists will protest at Azad Maidan, and submit a memorandum to the Chief Minister of Maharashtra, he added. The chemist body confirmed the 24-hour shutdown, even as reports suggested that some pharmacy associations were not participating in the protest.

A Health Ministry source said that hospital pharmacy stores, the government-run Jan Aushadhi and Amrit Pharmacy stores would be open on Wednesday.

PREDATORY PRICING

The AIOCD had called for a day-long strike about a week ago, against what it called “predatory pricing”, and submitted their concerns to the Prime Minister, saying that they had made repeated requests, but no concrete action had been taken on the issues affecting the pharmaceutical trade.

“Large corporate entities are disturbing market balance through deep discounting. While margins on essential medicines are fixed by the government (National Pharmaceutical Pricing Authority/Drugs Prices Control



A poster announcing the nationwide strike outside a medical store in Hyderabad on Tuesday **SIDHANT THAKUR**

Order), these entities are creating unfair competition. This is threatening the survival of small chemists in rural and semi-urban areas, which will ultimately destroy the accessible medicine supply system,” the AIOCD said.

NEED FOR REGULATION

They also called for the withdrawal of two government notifications — GSR 220(E) and GSR 817(E) — the first one had to do with facilitating home deliveries during Covid and the second sought to bring e-pharmacies within the regulatory framework, Shinde said.

The digital regulatory framework must be in place before companies are allowed to operate, he said, adding that presently e-commerce companies were taking advantage of these notifications and delivering critical medicines – that are governed by legislation involving its storage and distribution.

AIOCD General Secretary Rajiv Singhal alleged that people were able to buy any type of medicine on prescriptions generated in any part of the country, making it difficult to trace back to legitimate medical doctors.

On the inconvenience to people looking to buy medicines on Wednesday, he said local chemists were taking measures to address this.

Air India Boeing 787’s fuel switch module to be examined

Press Trust of India
New Delhi

A detailed examination will be carried out of an Air India Dreamliner aircraft’s fuel control switch module, which possibly had issues as reported by a pilot in February, and the airline said it is understood that the evaluation is being done as a measure of abundant caution.

On February 2, an Air India pilot reported a defect with the fuel control switch of the Boeing 787-8 plane VT-ANX after operating the AI132 flight.

The plane faced a fuel control switch issue during engine start in London on February 1.

Later, Air India carried out a precautionary re-inspections of the fuel control switch across all its operational Boeing 787 aircraft and no issues were identified during these checks.

DETAILED PROBE

Sources said the Directorate General of Civil Aviation (DGCA) has decided that a detailed examination of the particular switch module will be carried out at Boeing’s facility in the US.



PRECAUTIONARY RE-INSPECTIONS. An Air India pilot reported a defect with the fuel control switch of the Boeing 787-8 plane VT-ANX after operating the AI132 flight on February 2

In response to a query about the particular fuel control switch, an Air India

spokesperson on Tuesday said the fuel switch module had already been confirmed

Infrastructure demand to push global AI spending growth in 2026 to \$2.59 trillion

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

Global spending on AI is moving into a new phase, with investments increasingly shifting beyond applications towards the infrastructure needed to support AI systems. Gartner estimates worldwide AI spending will rise from \$1.76 trillion in 2025 to \$3.49 trillion by 2027, almost doubling in two years. It is forecast to total \$2.59 trillion in 2026, a 47 per cent increase year-over-year.

AI infrastructure is expected to account for the largest share of this growth. Spending in the segment is projected to increase from \$975.6 billion in 2025 to \$1.89 trillion in 2027, making up more than half of total AI ex-

penditure. The rise reflects growing investments in chips, cloud capacity, data centres and computing resources required to run advanced AI workloads.

MAJOR SPEND

AI services remain another major spending area, expected to grow from \$436 billion to \$759 billion over the same period. This points to increasing enterprise demand for implementation, integration and consulting support as companies move AI projects into production.

Software spending is also set to expand sharply, rising from \$283 billion in 2025 to \$638 billion in 2027, indicating wider adoption of AI-powered applications across industries. Spending on AI models is projected to nearly quadruple to \$59 billion,



highlighting stronger investment in foundation models and model development.

AI cybersecurity is emerging as one of the fastest-growing segments, with spending expected to rise from \$25.9 billion to \$86 billion by 2027 as companies focus on protecting systems, models and data.

Even AI data spending, though relatively small today, is expected to grow significantly to \$6.5 billion,

underlining the importance of high-quality datasets in the AI ecosystem.

“Through the next several years, the need for capacity will make AI infrastructure, including AI-optimised IaaS, AI-optimised servers, AI network fabric, AI processing semiconductors and devices, the largest segment of the market, accounting for over 45 per cent of spending, which will be driven by vendors,” said John-David Lovelock, Distinguished VP Analyst at Gartner.

“Within this segment, spending on AI-optimised servers will triple over the next five years to become the largest sub-segment, as cloud services providers expand capacity in anticipation of the workloads created by GenAI models and agentic workflows,” he said.

Musk loses OpenAI court battle against Sam Altman

Bloomberg



Elon Musk

A jury rejected Elon Musk’s claims that OpenAI under Sam Altman’s leadership betrayed its mission to benefit the public by morphing into a for-profit business, finding that he waited too long to sue the company.

The verdict reached on Monday in federal court in Oakland, California, follows a trial over the bitter feud between the entrepreneurs who worked together to launch the start-up in 2015.

“I think there is a substantial amount of evidence to support the jury’s findings,” US district judge Yvonne Gonzalez Rogers said when she accepted the nine-member jury’s unanimous conclusion after about two hours of deliberations.

The high-profile trial, in a case that has captivated Silicon Valley since Musk filed his complaint in 2024, was

the culmination of years of animosity between the OpenAI co-founders.

“The finding of the jury confirmed that what this lawsuit was a hypocrite’s hypocritical attempt to sabotage a competitor and to overcome a long history of very bad predictions about what OpenAI has been and will become,” OpenAI attorney William Savitt said.

Musk and his lawyers vowed an appeal, but didn’t get into specifics about what they will argue.

Airtel launches ₹449 ‘Priority Postpaid’ plan

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Bharti Airtel (Airtel) on Tuesday launched ‘Priority Postpaid’, a new service that leverages 5G slicing technology to deliver superior and more consistent experience to customers on postpaid, starting at ₹449, going up to ₹1,749 (+ GST) per month.

The service is available for customers on all its postpaid plans. Existing customers will start enjoying the benefit automatically, while pre-paid customers or customers wanting to switch to Airtel Priority postpaid can do so easily through the Airtel App or by visiting any Airtel Store, it said.

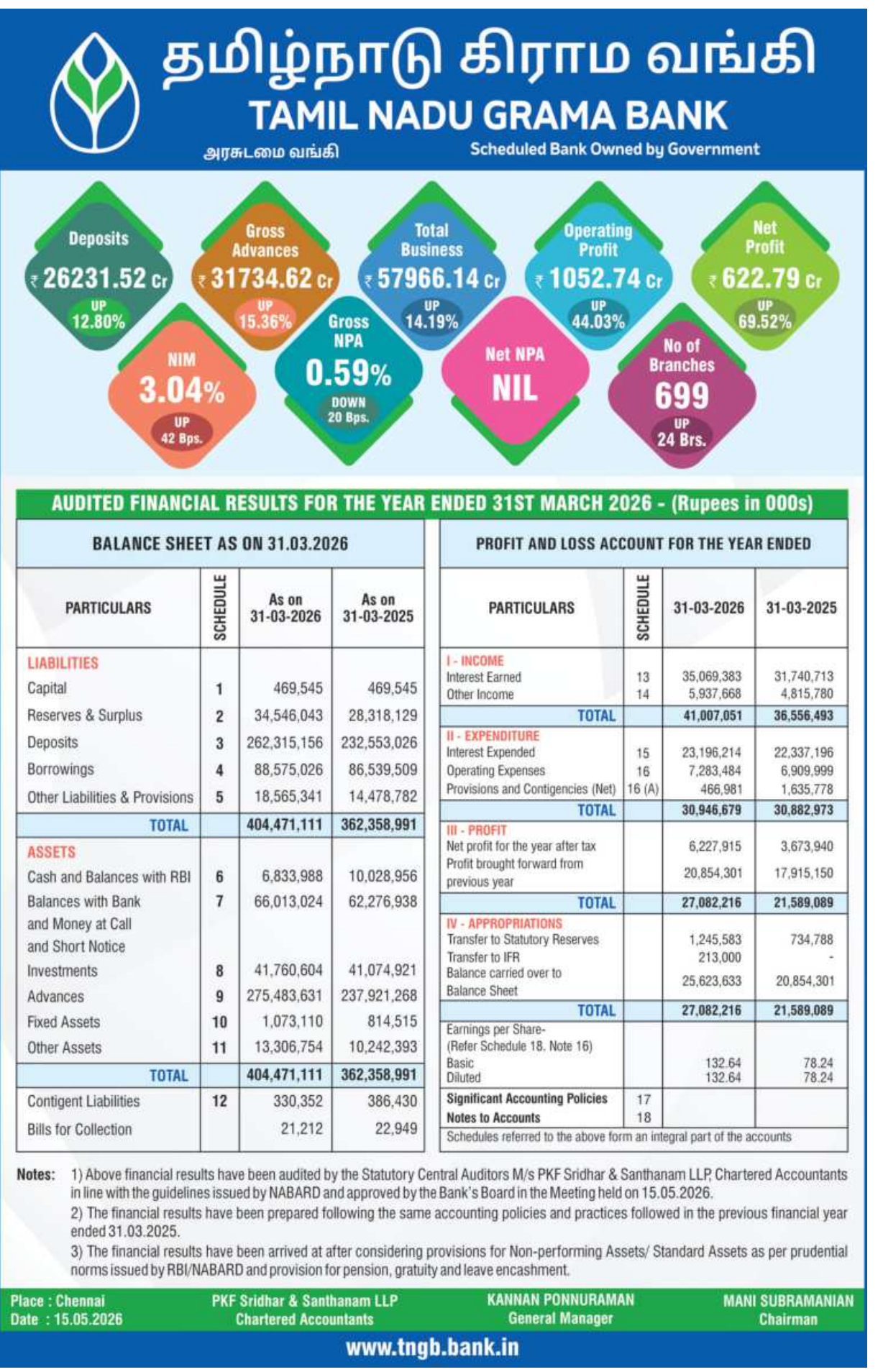
“Our focus at Airtel is on delivering meaningful innovations that enhance our customers’ experience. Priority Postpaid is our latest innovation powered by the 5G slicing technology. It provides a

superior, more reliable, and dependable experience to our customers – whether they are attending a client call in traffic, or streaming at a packed concert, or booking a cab in a crowded market,” Shashwat Sharma, Managing Director and Chief Executive Officer, Airtel, said.

ONLINE CONNECTIVITY

This service is specially built for busy customers who depend on uninterrupted connectivity for work, entertainment, or online collaboration, he said.

For the Priority Postpaid, Airtel has upgraded its 5G network with advanced capabilities of slicing technology. This makes the network more efficient, creates more capacity, and provides the capability to use this capacity in a targeted manner for delivery of a superior experience for priority customers, the company said.



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